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WORLDVIEWS ON EVIDENCE-BASED NURSING

REVIEW ARTICLE

Social media use and its impact on adults' mental health and well-being: A scoping review

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Abstract

Background: Social media use has grown in importance and prevalence, with its estimated number of users at 4.9 billion worldwide. Social media use research has revealed positive and negative impacts on users' mental health and well-being. However, such impacts among adults have not been examined in any reviews.

Methods: A scoping review was conducted based on the framework by Arksey and O'Malley and reported based on the PRISMA-ScR guidelines. Eight databases were searched from 2005 to December 2021. Articles were included after being reviewed by three independent teams, with discrepancies resolved through consensus with the senior author. Publication-related information (i.e., authors, year of publication, aims, study population, methodology, interventions, comparisons, outcome measures and key findings) were extracted from each study. Thematic analysis was conducted to answer the research questions.

Results: Among the 114 eligible articles, young adults (69.6%) represented the main age group. Most studies (78.6%) focused on the negative impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being, with nearly a third (32.1%) assessing such impacts on depression. Notably, this scoping review found that more than three-quarters (78.6%) of the included studies revealed that excessive and passive social media use would increases depression, anxiety, mood and loneliness. Nevertheless, a third (33.0%) also reported positive impacts, where positive and purposeful use of social media contributes to improvements in mental health and well-being, such as increased perceived social support and enjoyment.

Linking Evidence to Action: This review has provided an overview of the existing knowledge on how social media use affects adults and identified areas of research that merit investigation in future studies. More attention should be given to maximizing the positive impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being among adults.

KEYWORDS
addiction, adult, anxiety, depression, life satisfaction, mental health, mental well-being, scoping review, social media, social networking services

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INTRODUCTION

Social media, also known as social networking sites, have been woven into contemporary society globally. With 3.4 billion users recorded in 2019, social media use continues to grow at an estimated yearly rate of 9% (Karim et al., 2020). More recent statistics further estimated that in 2023, there would be 4.9 billion people using social media worldwide (Wong, 2023). Rapidly developing over the last two decades, social media have come to serve various purposes of connecting individuals, ranging from socializing with friends and family to employment and even initiating romantic relationships (Aichner et al., 2021). This phenomenon has garnered much scholarly interest in understanding the impacts of the expanding presence of social networking sites on the way of life of the global population.

Social media among individuals' mental health and well-being remains a novel research area (Karim et al., 2020; Schønning et al., 2020). While social media use may represent an enjoyable and satisfying experience, its effects have been reported to be inconclusive and conflicting. Evidence has shown the role of social media use in mitigating loneliness and providing social support and beneficial interactions among like-minded users, but negative online experiences may jeopardize mental health and well-being (Karim et al., 2020; Seabrook et al., 2016). Additionally, recent scoping reviews have either focused on the impacts of social media use on adolescents (Schønning et al., 2020) or adopted a cross-sectional perspective (Karim et al., 2020; Seabrook et al., 2016). While age-related differences were not found among adolescents (Schønning et al., 2020), the potentially varying impacts of social media use on young and middle-aged adults have not been examined in a nuanced and differentiated manner. Another layer of complexity arose from the disproportionately accentuated negative impacts exerted by social media use on the mental health of lesbian, gay, and bisexual (LGB) youths and young adults, especially given their use of social networking sites for social support (Berger et al., 2022; Escobar-Viera et al., 2018). However, subgroup analysis focusing on such impacts on LGB young and middle-aged adults has been lacking.

Of note, to our knowledge, there have not been any comprehensive reviews on how social media use affects the mental health of the adult population. It is essential to recognize that insights from the existing literature on this aspect will critically underpin future mental healthcare research and practice. Against this background, this review aims to understand the impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being among young and middle-aged adults. More specifically, in a novel attempt to generate an age-differentiated analysis, this review will explore research on such impacts on not only the general adult population but also sub-populations of minority demographics.

Defining key terms

This review defines the adult population as individuals aged 18 to 64, including young and middle-aged adults. The American Psychological Association (2022) defines young adults as individuals who are at least about 20 years of age, while the World Health Organization (World Health Organization [WHO], 2013) sets the threshold of adulthood at 19. Many databases and past studies consider 18 as the onset of adulthood. In keeping with the legal definitions in many countries, our team adopted 18 years of age as the lower bound for defining adulthood. The prevalence of social media has mirrored the rapid evolution of the Internet over the past two decades, evolving from simple communication at the outset to online virtual communities in contemporary contexts (Aichner et al., 2021). Given our focus on social media use in the past decade, this review adopted one of its definitions in recent decades as a highly interactive mobile and web-based digital platform that facilitates individuals in consuming, producing, and sharing user-generated content (Aichner et al., 2021).

Furthermore, this review defines mental health based on the WHO-endorsed broad definition as a state of well-being that enables individuals to cope with stressors in life, build healthy relationships with others, and realize their potential to contribute to society (WHO, 2022). In this regard, mental health needs to be viewed as a continuum between health and illness with varying lived experiences for individuals rather than simply as the absence of distressing and disabling mental illnesses and disorders (Galderisi et al., 2015).

METHODS

Given the broad spectrum of knowledge on social media usage, a scoping review was chosen to provide an overview of the literature. Using a scoping review, we can explore our research topic comprehensively by identifying literature gaps, including diverse study designs and sources, maintaining flexibility, and maximizing time and resource efficiency (Munn et al., 2018). In this review, we adopted the five-stage framework by Arksey and O'Malley (2005). We reported findings according to the PRISMA-ScR guidelines (Woo et al., 2022), thus ensuring the quality of this review. However, our team did not perform a formal quality appraisal on the included studies as the objective of scoping reviews is to map the extent of knowledge in the literature, which is similar to majority of the scoping reviews conducted in nursing (Woo et al., 2022).

Specifying the research questions

The primary research question guiding this review was 'What are the impacts of social media on adults' mental well-being'? Three secondary research questions were further formulated to underpin the primary one and served as a structure for collating the results:

1. Which aspects of mental health and well-being have thus far been examined in research on social media use among adults?
2. Have demographic factors been examined in such research, including age groups (young and middle-aged adults), genders, individual differences, and health conditions?

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3. What are the main findings on how social media use impacts adults' mental health and well-being, and what possible factors govern such impacts?

Identifying relevant literature

To identify studies on social media use and their impacts on adults' mental health, we formulated a search strategy (Table 1) with the help of university medical librarians. They suggested that we search eight subject-specific databases most suited to our research question based on a timeline from 2005 to December 2021, when there was a worldwide rise in social media use (Ortiz-Ospina, 2019). Quantitative and qualitative studies were included in this review. The search was conducted on eight databases: CINAHL, Cochrane Library, Embase, PubMed, PsycINFO, ProQuest, Scopus, and Web of Science. We used relevant keywords and Medical Subject Headings (MeSH) terms, including 'adult', 'young adult', 'middle age', 'social media' [MeSH], 'psychological and psychiatric' [MeSH], 'Mental Health', and 'Mental health care' [MeSH] (Table 2). The librarians further advised us not to specify the social media platforms as individual search terms were subsumed under 'social media' and 'social network*'. Where appropriate, we applied Boolean terms and truncation to maximize the retrieval of relevant articles.

Studies with keywords relevant to our research questions were included (Table 2). Other salient aspects in considering inclusion were as follows: beneficial and detrimental effects of social media use on adults' mental health and well-being; potential applications or interventions involving social media use to improve adults' mental health and well-being; factors affecting adults' social media use and its impacts; and effects of abstaining from social media use. Studies were deemed eligible for title- and abstract screening if they had discussed social media use and its benefits or adverse impacts on adults' mental health and well-being. Additionally, only publications in English were included, given the team's lack of access to interpreters.

Conversely, studies involving adolescents or older adults above 65 years old with no age-segregated results analysis were excluded. Likewise, we excluded studies that did not assess the use of social networking sites or social media, measured the impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being, or presented social media use-related findings. Finally, given our aim to examine real-life implications and experiences of social media use among adults, articles without participants were also deemed ineligible.

Selecting the studies

Upon retrieval from the databases, the studies were uploaded onto EndNote X9, where duplicates were electronically removed. This was followed by title and abstract screening of the remaining studies by three independent teams (each comprising two reviewers). Studies not meeting the eligibility criteria were removed, while those deemed eligible by at least one reviewer were downloaded for further examination. Any discrepancies in study selection were resolved monthly through consensus with the senior author during the entire review period. Hand-searching of end-references of the included studies was also conducted (Whittemore & Knafl, 2005). Additional studies with eligible titles and abstracts were retrieved for similar full-text screening, and discrepancies were likewise addressed by consulting the senior author.

Charting the data

A data-extraction table was developed iteratively on Microsoft Excel based on the research questions of this review. The tabulated information included the authors/countries, years of publication, aims, study population, methodology, interventions, comparisons, outcome measures and key findings. The first and senior authors conducted pilot testing of the table independently based on the first five papers. Subsequently, each of the six authors independently extracted, summarized, and charted data for individual studies. The senior author checked all data and then counter-checked by the first author.

Collating, summarizing, and reporting the results

Once the data had been extracted from all the included papers, thematic analyses were conducted (Arksey & O'Malley, 2005; Mak & Thomas, 2022). Through thematic analysis, the impact of social media on adults was grouped into themes and subthemes (Braun & Clarke, 2012). Six phases were involved. The initial stage of familiarizing with primary data was followed by the researchers independently performing line-by-line analysis with Microsoft Word. Inductive coding was used to generate meaningful initial codes; then, the researchers actively searched for themes from the coded data. Next, the codes were re-organized, and patterns and meanings were used to generate preliminary subthemes and themes. Finally, the finalized subthemes and themes were rearranged to ensure the research questions were answered and the overall findings were coherent. The first author undertook the greater responsibility in data synthesis. However, themes, subthemes, and syntheses were discussed with the senior author throughout the process.

RESULTS

The initial search yielded 14,018 articles, from which 1150 duplicates were removed. The remaining 12,868 articles were subjected to title and abstract screening, of which 12,401 were deemed irrelevant. The remaining 467 potential articles' full texts were retrieved and screened, leading to the final inclusion of 114 articles (see Supplementary File Appendix S1 for complete reference lists of included articles). Most studies were excluded because they had not

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TABLE 1 Search strategies.

Embase
(('adult'/exp OR 'adult') AND [adult]/lim AND [humans]/lim AND [english]/lim AND [abstracts]/lim) **AND** ('social media'/exp AND [adult]/lim AND [humans]/lim AND [english]/lim AND [abstracts]/lim) **AND** (('psychological and psychiatric procedures' OR 'mental health'/exp OR 'mental health care'/exp OR 'psychiatric diagnosis'/exp OR 'psychiatric theories and schools' OR 'psychiatric treatment' OR 'convulsive therapy' OR 'counter transference' OR 'crisis intervention' OR 'electroconvulsive therapy' OR 'hypnosis' OR 'narcotherapy' OR 'observation' OR 'psychoanalysis' OR 'psychopharmacotherapy'/exp OR 'psychotherapy' OR 'suggestion' OR 'transference'/exp OR 'psychodynamics'/exp OR 'psychiatry'/exp OR 'mental disease' OR 'behavioral science' OR 'parapsychology'/exp OR 'psychology'/exp) AND 'psychomotor disorder' OR 'psychiatric department'/exp OR 'psychiatric nursing' OR 'recidivism' OR 'anxiety'/exp OR 'sleep disorder' OR 'wellbeing' OR 'psychological well-being' OR 'quality of life' OR 'happiness' OR 'welfare' OR 'human relation' OR 'friendship' OR 'friend' OR 'social support') OR ((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depression? OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychosis* OR psychoses* OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR 'self injur*' OR 'self harm' OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR 'traumatic stress' OR amnesia* OR amnestic* OR 'obsessive compulsive disorder' OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR 'well-being' OR life) AND (quality OR 'quality of life' OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend? OR friendship? OR 'human relation' OR 'interpersonal relationship' OR 'social support')) AND [adult]/lim AND [humans]/lim AND [english]/lim AND [abstracts]/lim AND [embase]/lim
CINAHL
"adult" OR "young adult" OR "middle age" **AND** "social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network*" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin **AND** (('psychological and psychiatric procedures' OR 'mental health'/exp OR 'mental health care' OR 'psychiatric diagnosis' OR 'psychiatric theories and schools' OR 'psychiatric treatment' OR 'convulsive therapy' OR 'counter transference' OR 'crisis intervention' OR 'electroconvulsive therapy' OR 'hypnosis' OR 'narcotherapy' OR 'observation' OR 'psychoanalysis' OR 'psychopharmacotherapy' OR 'psychotherapy' OR 'suggestion' OR 'transference' OR 'psychodynamics' OR 'psychiatry' OR 'mental disease' OR 'behavioral science' OR 'parapsychology' OR 'psychology') AND ('psychomotor disorder' OR 'psychiatric department' OR 'psychiatric nursing' OR 'recidivism' OR 'anxiety' OR 'sleep disorder' OR 'wellbeing' OR 'psychological well-being' OR 'quality of life' OR 'happiness' OR 'welfare' OR 'human relation' OR 'friendship' OR 'friend' OR 'social support')) **OR** ((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depression OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychosis* OR psychoses* OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR 'self injur*' OR 'self harm' OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR 'traumatic stress' OR amnesia* OR amnestic* OR 'obsessive compulsive disorder' OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR 'well-being' OR life) AND (quality OR 'quality of life' OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend? OR friendship? OR 'human relation' OR 'interpersonal relationship' OR 'social support')
Scopus
("adult" OR "young adult" OR "middle age") **AND** ("social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network*" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin) AND ((("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR "hypnosis" OR "narcotherapy" OR "observation" OR "psychoanalysis" OR "psychopharmacotherapy" OR "psychotherapy" OR "suggestion" OR "transference" OR "psychodynamics" OR "psychiatry" OR "mental disease" OR "behavioral science" OR "parapsychology" OR "psychology") **AND** ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR "recidivism" OR "anxiety" OR "sleep disorder" OR "wellbeing" OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR "happiness" OR "welfare" OR "human relation" OR "friendship" OR "friend" OR "social support")) **OR** ((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depression OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychosis* OR psychoses* OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR "self injur*" OR "self harm" OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR "traumatic stress" OR amnesia* OR amnestic* OR "obsessive compulsive disorder" OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR "well-being" OR life) AND (quality OR "quality of life" OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend OR friendship OR "human relation" OR "interpersonal relationship" OR "social support"))) **AND** (LIMIT-TO (PUBSTAGE, "final")) AND (LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, "SOCI") OR LIMIT-TO (SUBJAREA, "PSYC")) AND (LIMIT-TO (DOCTYPE, "ar")) AND (LIMIT-TO (LANGUAGE, "English")) AND (LIMIT-TO (EXACTKEYWORD, "Adult") OR LIMIT-TO (EXACTKEYWORD, "Young Adult") OR LIMIT-TO (EXACTKEYWORD, "Social Media") OR LIMIT-TO (EXACTKEYWORD, "Social Networking"))
PsycINFO

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TABLE 1 (Continued)

(adult or young adult or middle age).mp. [mp = title, abstract, heading word, table of contents, key concepts, original title, tests & measures, mesh word]

AND (social media or facebook or twitter or instagram or snapchat or tumblr or social network* or tiktok or youtube or myspace or whatsapp or pinterest or weibo or wechat or linkedin).mp. [mp = title, abstract, heading word, table of contents, key concepts, original title, tests & measures, mesh word]

AND ("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR hypnosis OR narcotherapy OR observation OR psychoanalysis OR psychopharmacotherapy OR psychotherapy OR suggestion OR transference OR psychodynamics OR psychiatry OR "mental disease" OR "behavioral science" OR parapsychology OR psychology) AND ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR recidivism OR anxiety OR "sleep disorder" OR wellbeing OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR happiness OR welfare OR "human relation" OR friendship OR friend OR "social support") **OR** ((mental or psychiatric* or psychologic* or mood or dissociat* or neurotic or sleep or sleeping or insanit* or psychopatholog* or depression or depressive or depressed or anxiety or anxieties or bipolar* or schizophren* or psychotic* or psychosis* or psychoses* or bipolar or mania or manic or anorexi* or bulimi* or borderline or self injur* or self harm or suicide or alcohol or eating or personality or panic* or phobic* or traumatic stress or amnesia* or amnestic* or obsessive compulsive disorder or ((multiple or dual) adj (personalit* or identit*)) or wellbeing or well-being or life) and (((quality or quality) adj life) or thrive or thriving or contentment or happiness or welfare or friend or friendship or human relation or interpersonal relationship or social support)).mp. [mp = title, abstract, heading word, table of contents, key concepts, original title, tests & measures, mesh word]

Limit to (full text and human and English language and abstracts)

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("adult age" OR "young adult age" OR "middle age adult")

AND ("social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network*" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin)

AND ((("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR hypnosis OR narcotherapy OR observation OR psychoanalysis OR psychopharmacotherapy OR psychotherapy OR suggestion OR transference OR psychodynamics OR psychiatry OR "mental disease" OR "behavioral science" OR parapsychology OR psychology) AND ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR recidivism OR anxiety OR "sleep disorder" OR wellbeing OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR happiness OR welfare OR "human relation" OR friendship OR friend OR "social support")) **OR** ((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depression OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychosis* OR psychoses* OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR "self injur*" OR "self harm" OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR "traumatic stress" OR amnesia* OR amnestic* OR "obsessive compulsive disorder" OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR "well-being" OR life) AND (quality OR "quality of life" OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend? OR friendship? OR "human relation" OR "interpersonal relationship" OR "social support")))

PubMed

((adult or "young adult" or "middle age adult" AND ((fha[Filter]) AND (booksdocs[Filter] OR clinicaltrial[Filter] OR randomizedcontrolledtrial[Filter]) AND (fft[Filter])))

AND ("social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network*" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin AND ((fha[Filter]) AND (booksdocs[Filter] OR clinicaltrial[Filter] OR randomizedcontrolledtrial[Filter]) AND (fft[Filter]))))

AND (((("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR hypnosis OR narcotherapy OR observation OR psychoanalysis OR psychopharmacotherapy OR psychotherapy OR suggestion OR transference OR psychodynamics OR psychiatry OR "mentaldisease" OR "behavioral science" OR parapsychology OR psychology) AND ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR recidivism OR anxiety OR "sleep disorder" OR wellbeing OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR happiness OR welfare OR "human relation" OR friendship OR friend OR "social support")) AND ((fha[Filter]) AND (booksdocs[Filter] OR clinicaltrial[Filter] OR randomizedcontrolledtrial[Filter]) AND (fft[Filter]))) **OR** (((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depression OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychosis* OR psychoses* OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR "self injur*" OR "self harm" OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR "traumatic stress" OR amnesia* OR amnestic* OR "obsessive compulsive disorder" OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR "well-being" OR life) AND (quality OR "quality of life" OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend? OR friendship? OR "human relation" OR "interpersonal relationship" OR "social support"))

AND *((fha[Filter]) AND (booksdocs[Filter] OR clinicaltrial[Filter] OR randomizedcontrolledtrial[Filter]) AND (fft[Filter]))) AND ((fha[Filter]) AND (booksdocs[Filter] OR clinicaltrial[Filter] OR randomizedcontrolledtrial[Filter]) AND (fft[Filter])))*

Quoted phrases not found: "psychological and psychiatric procedures", "psychiatric theories and schools"

Cochrane

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TABLE 1 (Continued)

adult OR "young adult" OR "middle age adult" in Title Abstract Keyword
AND "social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin in Title Abstract Keyword
AND ((("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR hypnosis OR narcotherapy OR observation OR psychoanalysis OR psychopharmacotherapy OR psychotherapy OR suggestion OR transference OR psychodynamics OR psychiatry OR "mental disease" OR "behavioral science" OR parapsychology OR psychology) AND ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR recidivism OR anxiety OR "sleep disorder" OR wellbeing OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR happiness OR welfare OR "human relation" OR friendship OR friend OR "social support")) **OR** ((mental OR psychiatric OR psychological OR mood OR dissociate OR dissociation OR neurotic OR sleep OR sleeping OR insanity OR psychopathology OR depression OR depressive OR depressed OR anxiety OR anxieties OR bipolar OR schizophrenia OR schizophrenic OR psychotic OR psychosis OR psychoses OR bipolar OR mania OR manic OR anorexia OR anorexic OR bulimia OR bulimic OR borderline OR "self injury" OR "self injure" OR "self harm" OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic OR phobic OR "traumatic stress" OR amnesia OR amnestic OR "obsessive compulsive disorder" OR ((multiple OR dual) AND adj AND (personality OR identity)) OR wellbeing OR "well-being" OR life) AND (quality OR "quality of life" OR thrive OR thriving OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend? OR friendship? OR "human relation" OR "interpersonal relationship" OR "social support"))) in Title Abstract Keyword

Web of Science

TS = (adult or "young adult" or "middle age adult")
AND TS = ("social media" OR facebook OR twitter OR instagram OR snapchat OR tumblr OR "social network*" OR tiktok OR youtube OR myspace OR whatsapp OR pinterest OR weibo OR wechat OR linkedin)
AND TS = (("psychological and psychiatric procedures" OR "mental health" OR "mental health care" OR "psychiatric diagnosis" OR "psychiatric theories and schools" OR "psychiatric treatment" OR "convulsive therapy" OR "counter transference" OR "crisis intervention" OR "electroconvulsive therapy" OR hypnosis OR narcotherapy OR observation OR psychoanalysis OR psychopharmacotherapy OR psychotherapy OR suggestion OR transference OR psychodynamics OR psychiatry OR "mental disease" OR "behavioral science" OR parapsychology OR psychology) AND ("psychomotor disorder" OR "psychiatric department" OR "psychiatric nursing" OR recidivism OR anxiety OR "sleep disorder" OR wellbeing OR "psychological well-being" OR "quality of life" OR happiness OR welfare OR "human relation" OR friend* OR "social support")) **OR** TS = (((mental OR psychiatric* OR psychologic* OR mood OR dissociat* OR neurotic OR sleep* OR insanit* OR psychopatholog* OR depress* OR anxiet* OR bipolar* OR schizophren* OR psychotic* OR psychos* OR bipolar OR mani* OR anorexi* OR bulimi* OR borderline OR "self injur*" OR "self harm" OR suicide OR alcohol OR eating OR personality OR panic* OR phobic* OR "traumatic stress" OR amnes* OR "obsessive compulsive disorder" OR ((multiple OR dual) AND (personalit* OR identit*)) OR wellbeing OR "well-being" OR life) AND (quality OR "quality of life" OR thriv* OR contentment OR happiness OR welfare OR friend* OR "human relation" OR "interpersonal relationship" OR "social support")))
AND (DT==("ARTICLE" OR "EARLY ACCESS" OR "DATA PAPER" OR "BOOK CHAPTER")

explicitly examined social media use and mental health or well-being. Figure 1 outlines the screening process. Information underpinning our subsequent formulation of themes was tabulated: authors/country, year of publication, aims, study population, methodology, intervention, group/comparison, outcome measures and key findings. Table 3 outlines the selected characteristics of the screened articles, all published in academic journals. The studies originated from 25 countries, with the most common ones being the United States (39.3%), China (11.6%), and Germany (7.1%).

Descriptions of included studies

Of the 114 included studies, the majority ($n = 106$, 93%) focused on healthy individuals. University students and young adults (18 to 35 years of age) were the predominant age group explored among the studies ($n = 80$, 70.2%). Nine studies (8.0%) focused on females, while another examined LGB individuals (Escobar-Viera et al., 2018). Populations with medical conditions were also involved: young adults diagnosed with depression or anxiety disorders (Şentürk et al., 2021); inpatients of a psychosomatic rehabilitation clinic (Brailovskaia et al., 2019); individuals under treatment for eating disorders in a group setting (Saffran et al., 2016); individuals with intellectual disability (Shpigelman, 2016); adults with cleft lip or palate (Stock et al., 2018); post-surgical adults with non-small cell lung cancer (Sui et al., 2019); adults with obsessive–compulsive-related disorders in online peer-support groups (Tan et al., 2021); and adults with self-reported autism spectrum disorders (Ward et al., 2018).

Social media platforms used

Facebook represented the most investigated platform ($n = 47$, 41.2%) among the included studies. This was followed by Instagram ($n = 18$, 15.8%), Twitter ($n = 15$, 13.2%), Snapchat ($n = 9$, 8.0%), YouTube ($n = 7$, 6.1%), WeChat ($n = 7$, 6.1%), and WhatsApp ($n = 6$, 5.3%). Miscellaneous platforms included Telegram (Abu-Snieneh et al., 2019), XING (Brandenberg et al., 2019), Google+, LinkedIn, Tumblr, Vine, Reddit, and Pinterest (Primack et al., 2017; Shensa et al., 2016; Shensa, Sidani, Dew, et al., 2018; Sidani et al., 2020; Vannucci et al., 2017).

Aspects of mental health and well-being assessed

More than half of the studies ($n = 60$, 52.6%) assessed mental health outcomes. While some addressed depression, stress, and anxiety,

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TABLE 2 Keywords for inclusion of studies.

Keywords	Descriptors
Adult	Used as an age indicator in human or animal studies; in humans, 18–64 years of age
Social media (social networking services)	Facebook; Flickr; Instagram; LinkedIn; MySpace; Pinterest; Reddit; Sina Weibo; Snapchat; social networking platform; social networking site; social networking website; social platform; TikTok; Tumblr; Twitter; WeChat; WhatsApp; YouTube
Mental health	Condition, mental; health, mental; mental care; mental condition; mental factor; mental help; mental service; mental state; mental status; mental status schedule; psychic health
Mental disease	Abnormal mental state; disease, mental; diseased mental state; disorder, mental; disordered mental state; disturbed mental state; illness, mental; insanity; mental abnormality; mental change; mental confusion; mental defect; mental disorder; mental disorders; mental disorders diagnosed in childhood; mental disturbance; mental illness; mental insufficiency; mental symptom; mentally ill; neurodevelopmental disorder; neurodevelopmental disorders; neuropsychiatric disease; neuropsychiatric diseases; neuropsychiatric disorder; neuropsychiatric disorders; psychiatric disease; psychiatric disorder; psychiatric illness; psychiatric symptom; psychic disease; psychic disorder; psychic disturbance; psychologic disorder; psychologic disturbance; psychological disorder; psychological disturbance; psychopathology
Psychological well-being	Eudaimonic well-being; eudaimonic well-being; eudaimonic well-being; mental well-being; mental well-being; mental well-being; psychological well-being; psychological well-being; psychological well-being

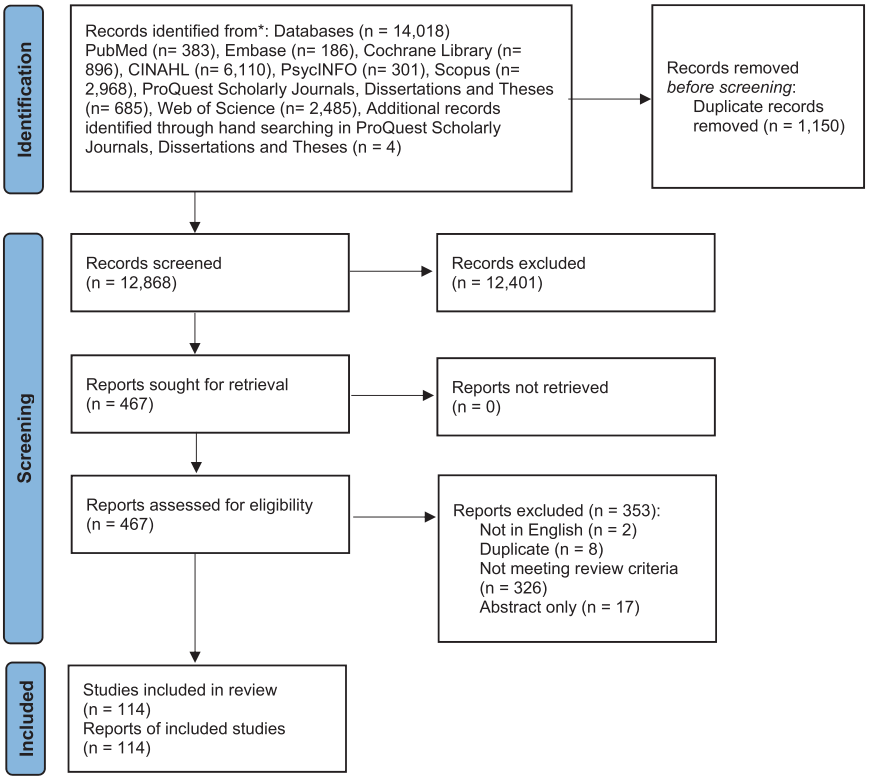


FIGURE 1 PRISMA flow diagram.

others addressed a combination of these. Thirty-six studies (32.2%) evaluated the impacts of social media use on depression and depressive symptoms, 18 (15.8%) evaluated the impacts on stress, and 29 (25.4%) evaluated the impacts on anxiety and anxiety-related symptoms. Other aspects examined included: social media use-related addiction ($n=7$, 6.1%; Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Brailovskaia, Schillack, et al., 2020; Pontes et al., 2018; Şentürk et al., 2021; Tang & Koh, 2017; Thomson et al., 2021; Xie & Karan, 2019); obsessive–compulsive symptoms ($n=2$, 1.8%; Erliksson et al., 2020; Tan et al., 2021); eating disorders ($n=2$, 1.8%; Saffran et al., 2016; Smith et al., 2013); personality disorders ($n=1$, 0.9%; Rosen et al., 2013); and mood disorders ($n=2$, 1.8%; Rosen et al., 2013; Tang & Koh, 2017).

Three-quarters of the studies ($n=86$, 75.4%) focused on the impacts of social media use on psychological well-being (typically assessed in parallel with outcomes on mental health). Notable aspects of well-being assessed were: life satisfaction ($n=11$, 9.8%); sleep quality ($n=15$, 13.4%); self-perception ($n=12$, 10.7%);

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TABLE 3 Selected characteristics of included studies.

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Aalbers et al.	2019	Netherlands	To further understand the relations between passive social media use (PSMU) and depression symptoms.	Undergraduate psychology students.	Smart phones to complete a questionnaire seven times daily for 14 days.
Abu-Snieneh et al.	2019	Saudi Arabia	To identify the relationship between social media addiction, sleep problems, and the cumulative grade point average (GPA) of the study participants.	University students.	Participants completed an electronic questionnaire.
Achdut et al.	2021	Israel	To examine: (1) the association between subjective poverty, material deprivation, social capital, and psychological distress among young adults; (2) whether social capital mediates the association between subjective poverty, material deprivation and PD; (3) whether there are differences in the mediating effect of the various social capital practices considered here.	Young adults.	Participants completed an electronic questionnaire.
Akin & Akin	2015	Turkey	To examine the mediating role of social safeness on the relationship between Facebook use and life satisfaction.	University students.	Questionnaire administered by the researchers to the students.
Aldhawyan et al.	2020	Saudi Arabia	To investigate the rate of poor sleep quality (PSQ) among freshman college students and to identify the determinants of PSQ, including their sociodemographic features, lifestyle characteristics, and health-risk factors.	Freshman college students.	Questionnaire administered by the researchers to the students.
Asiri et al.	2018	Saudi Arabia	To assess the impact of using social media on sleep quality and to identify risk factors associated with poor sleep quality among medical students.	Medical students.	Anonymous self-administered questionnaire.
Atroszko et al.	2018	Poland	1. To provide data on the validity and reliability of the measurement of Facebook addiction. 2. Investigate the relative contribution of different personality characteristics to Facebook addiction within an integrated model, as well as the unique contribution of Facebook addiction in terms of explaining different facets of well-being above and beyond personality characteristics that consistently have been shown to be related to psychosocial functioning.	Polish university students.	Students were invited to participate anonymously in the study during lectures or classes.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depression symptoms. 2. Stress. 3. PSMU. 4. Loneliness.	1. Engaging in PSMU did not predict depression symptoms, loneliness, or stress. Instead, previous fatigue and loneliness predicted PSMU, indicating that these symptoms might lead participants to scroll through social media pages. 2. Within the same timeframe, PSMU co-occurred with loss of interest, concentration problems, fatigue, and loneliness.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media use. 2. Sleep quality. 3. GPA.	1. The strongest predictor of having very poor sleep quality was addiction on Twitter. 2. Those who are not addicted on Instagram were two times more likely to achieve excellent GPA scores than their addictive counterparts.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Psychological distress. 2. Subjective poverty. 3. Social capital.	1. Informal social capital buffered the negative effect of subjective poverty and material deprivations on psychological distress, whereas use of online social networks increased it. 2. The use of online social networks, however, promoted informal social capital, which, in turn, was a protective factor against psychological distress.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook addiction. 2. Social safeness. 3. Life satisfaction.	1. People who use Facebook more excessively may be more inclined to have unhealthy social relationships, leading to lower social safeness. 2. Life satisfaction was negatively correlated with Facebook use. 3. Life satisfaction was found to be associated positively with social safeness and associated with perceived social support. 4. Social safeness partially mediated the relationship between Facebook use and life satisfaction.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Sleep quality.	1. There was a significant difference in the PSQ rate between males and females, those who were physically active and those who were not, those who were mentally depressed and those who were not, and those with anxiety and those without. 2. The risk of PSQ was lower among students who used SM for education, had higher laptop usage, and had higher SM usage during daytime. The risk of PSQ was higher among those who reported SM usage at bedtime.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Extent of using the WhatsApp and/or Twitter. 2. Sleep Quality.	1. Twitter/WhatsApp use was significantly more among female than male medical students. 2. Quality of sleep differed significantly according to students' daily use of Twitter/WhatsApp, with highest prevalence of poor sleep quality among those who spend more than 4 h daily using Twitter/WhatsApp.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook addiction. 2. Personality traits. 3. Loneliness. 4. Social anxiety. 5. Stress. 6. General health, sleep quality and quality of life. 7. Self-efficacy. 8. Narcissism.	1. The investigated model showed that Facebook addiction was related to higher extraversion, narcissism, loneliness, social anxiety, and lower general self-efficacy. 2. Facebook addiction was further related to impoverished well-being (impaired general health, decreased sleep quality, and higher perceived stress), which is congruent with previous findings.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Austin-McCain	2017	United States	To examine the association of social media use with the satisfaction of daily routines and healthy lifestyle habits for undergraduate and graduate students.	Undergraduate and graduate university students.	Surveys were administered in classes prior to or after a session.
Aydin et al.	2021	Turkey	This study aimed to investigate the effects of social media addiction on depression in adult individuals. For this purpose, the researchers analyzed whether social media dependence had differing impacts according to various variables (age, gender, the highest level of education, duration of daily use of social media, frequency of social media use, etc.).	Adults.	Online questionnaire.
Barker	2009	USA	H1 participants reporting high group identification and positive collective self-esteem when using SNS. H2 those exhibiting negative collective self-esteem is an important motive for SNS use would be to seek a form of virtual companionship. H3 proposed that participants with high group identification and collective self-esteem would be more likely to seek SIG. H4 and 5 posited that females would be more motivated to use SNS to communicate with close peer group members (H4), while males would be more motivated to use SNS for learning purposes (H5).	803 University freshman.	Questionnaire.
Berryman et al.	2017	USA	1. Could reliance on social media for social interactions pejoratively influence real-life social contacts, leading to isolation and loneliness? 2. Could social media use isolate people from close contact and communication with others, thereby decreasing empathy? 3. Could overuse of social media lead to larger problems with mental health including suicidal ideation?	University students.	Questionnaire administered by the researchers to the students.
Brailovskaia et al.	2019	Germany	To investigate differences in variables of positive mental health (PMH) and negative mental health (NMH) between clinical inpatients who use the social platform Facebook and those who do not use Facebook.	Inpatients of a psychosomatic rehabilitation clinic.	Computer survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media use. 2. Healthy living habits. 3. Satisfaction with daily routine.	1. Social media use is substantially related to certain healthy lifestyle habits, such as relaxation, leisure, and social participation activities, as well as satisfaction with daily routine. 2. No significant association was found between other healthy habits, such as fitness and healthy eating.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media addiction. 2. Depression.	1. Significant differences were found between depression and social media dependency in variables such as the number of children, age, and income. 2. When social media addiction was examined in terms of gender among sociodemographic variables, no significant difference was found.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Motive for use. Motive for SIG. Group identification & collective self-esteem. Frequency of use.	Communication with peer group members was the most important motivation for SNS use. Participants high in positive collective self-esteem were strongly motivated to communicate with peer group via SNS. Females were more likely to report high positive collective self-esteem, greater overall use, and SNS use to communicate with peers. Females also posted higher means for group-in-self, passing time, and entertainment. Negative collective self-esteem correlated with social compensation, suggesting that those who felt negatively about their social group used SNS as an alternative to communicating with other group members. Males were more likely than females to report negative collective self-esteem and SNS use for social compensation and social identity gratifications.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Vague booking. 2. Time spent on social media. 3. Social media importance. 4. Mental health symptoms. 5. Social support. 6. Parent–child relationship. 7. Social anxiety. 8. Histrionic symptoms. 9. Needing to belong. 10. Loneliness. 11. Empathy. 12. Socially desirable responding.	1. Social media use is a poor predictor of mental health problems and concerns about social media precipitating a mental health crisis may be unwarranted. The exception was vague booking, which predicted loneliness and suicidal thoughts. 2. Our results are generally consistent with previous work which suggests that how individuals use social media is more critical than time spent online in regards to mental health.
Not applicable.	1. Facebook users. 2. Non-Facebook users.	1. Use of social networking sites. 2. PMH. 3. NMH.	1. Facebook users had significantly higher values of three variables of NMH (i.e., depressiveness, social stress and insomnia), and significantly lower values of PMH than Facebook nonusers. 2. Duration of daily Facebook use was significantly negatively associated with PMH and significantly positively with all variables of NMH.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Brailovskaia et al.	2018	Germany	This study explored the Facebook addiction disorder (FAD) in Germany.	Employees and university students.	Online survey.
Brailovskaia et al.	2020a	Germany	The current study investigated the reasons for social media use (SMU), as well as their relationships with daily stress, depression and anxiety symptoms, experience of flow during the usage process and tendencies of addictive SMU.	Adults.	Online survey was sent by the authors.
Brailovskaia et al.	2020b	Germany	To study whether Facebook addiction disorder predicts suicide-related outcomes, and whether positive mental health buffers this effect.	Facebook users.	Online survey.
Brailovskaia et al.	2021	Germany, Lithuania	To study problematic social media use in Lithuania and Germany and its relations to life satisfaction, depression, anxiety and stress symptoms.	Social media users who were university students.	Online survey.
Brandenberg et al.	2019	Germany	To compare behavior and activity on professional and private social networking sites.	Adult users of XING and Facebook.	Online survey.
Brown et al.	2021	USA / UK	To study how one's Facebook network affects their feelings of loneliness.	International university students.	Online survey.
Brown & Tiggemann	2016	Australia	To examine the effect of celebrity images, compared with equally attractive (unknown) peer, and control (travel) images, on women's body image.	Young adult females.	Tested individually or in small groups of two or three.
Campisi et al.	2012	USA	Examined undergraduate college student perceptions of Facebook use and incidence of upper respiratory infections (URIs).	College undergraduates.	Initial web-survey, followed by 10-week diary.
Cano et al.	2020	USA	To study how experiencing social media discrimination affects symptoms of depression and anxiety.	Hispanic young adults.	Online survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Narcissism. 2. Depression and anxiety. 3. Facebook addiction disorder. 4. Subjective happiness. 5. Resilience. 6. Facebook use frequency.	1. FAD was significantly positively related to Facebook use frequency, the personality trait narcissism, as well as depression and anxiety symptoms, but also to subjective happiness. Its association with resilience was significantly negative. 2. Facebook use frequency partly mediated the positive relationship between narcissism and FAD. 3. The positive relationship between FAD and happiness contributes to the understanding of the mechanisms that are involved in the development and maintenance of FAD, and partly explains earlier inconsistencies.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Use of social media. 2. Social media flow. 3. Addictive social media use. 4. Daily stress. 5. Depression and anxiety symptoms.	1. Five main categories of usage reasons were identified by an inductive qualitative content analysis: 'Search for Information and Inspiration', 'Search for Social Interaction', 'Beat of Boredom and Pastimes', 'Escape from Negative Emotions', and "Search for Positive Emotions," 2. Flow experiences positively predicted the categories 'Escape from Negative Emotions' and 'Search for Positive Emotions'. he last one was additionally predicted by less depression symptoms. 3. Only the category 'Escape from Negative Emotions' positively predicted tendencies of addictive SMU.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook addiction. 2. Positive mental health. 3. Suicidal behavior.	1. Addictive Facebook use may enhance the risk of suicide-related outcomes. 2. Positive mental health contributes to the reduction of this risk.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Problematic social media use. 2. Flow experienced during social media use 3. Life satisfaction. 4. Depression. 5. Anxiety and stress symptoms.	1. Those with low problematic social media use had the lowest levels of depression, anxiety and stress symptoms as well as the highest levels of life satisfaction and lowest levels of overall flow. 2. More Lithuanian participants had high social media withdrawal compared to German participants. No differences in proportion of those with high social media use were found. 3. This suggests that high problematic social media use correlates with poorer psychosocial outcomes.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1.Social comparison orientation. 2. Depression. 3. Self-esteem.	1. Both private and professional social networking site use is positively correlated to ability-related social comparison orientation and depressive tendencies. 2. Both private and professional social networking site use negatively correlated to self-esteem. 3. Users' general and opinion-related social comparison orientation were solely positively correlated to Facebook use.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook network size. 2. Loneliness.	1. Those with a larger network size reported significantly lower feelings of loneliness. 2. Network density, number of clusters, and average path length were not significantly related to loneliness.
Viewing and rating Instagram images.	Not applicable.	1. Social network site usage. 2. Negative mood and body dissatisfaction. 3. State appearance comparison. 4. Celebrity worship.	1. Exposure to celebrity and peer images increased negative mood and body dissatisfaction relative to travel images, with no significant difference between celebrity and peer images. This effect was mediated by state appearance comparison. 2. Celebrity worship moderated an increased effect of celebrity images on body dissatisfaction.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook use and perceptions. 2. Self-report URI symptoms.	1. The social network size was significantly related to the rate of URI, such that, the larger the social network, the greater the incidence rate of URI. 2. Most respondents experienced some degree of Facebook-induced stress. The effects of Facebook-induced stress on incidence of URI varied across the social network size, such that, the impact of stress on the URI incidence rate increased with the size of the social network.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Self-esteem. 2. Social media discrimination. 3. Depression symptoms. 4. Generalized anxiety symptoms.	1. Higher social media discrimination was significantly associated with higher symptoms of depression and anxiety but not self-esteem. 2. Higher social media discrimination was significantly associated with symptoms of depression and generalized anxiety among men but not women.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Castillo de Mesa et al.	2019	Spain	To examine whether 'connectedness' in social networking sites improves online social capital and resilience of social service users.	Adult social service users.	Analysis of online content.
Chan	2018	China	To study the relationships among different smartphone uses (i.e., voice, email, SMS, Facebook, WhatsApp), perceived relationship quality and subjective well-being.	Adults.	Computer-assisted telephone interviewing.
Chen & Bello	2017	U.S.	Assessed if receiving and providing social support on Facebook reduces stress, which subsequently improves life satisfaction.	University undergraduates.	Online survey.
Cole et al.	2019	USA	To study the association relation between measures of online social media use and in-person social support with depressive symptoms.	English-speaking adults.	Online surveys at the start and 4 months later.
Das-Friebel et al.	2020	UK	To study if bedtime social media use affects sleep and affective well-being.	University students.	Daily online surveys and wrist-worn actigraphs measurements for 14 days.
De Vries and Kuhne	2015	Netherlands	To study the indirect relationship between Facebook use and self-perceptions through negative social comparison.	Young adults.	Online surveys.
Dodemaide et al.	2021	Australia	To study the relationships between social media and the therapeutic affordance of young adults.	Young adults.	Online surveys.
Dubar et al.	2021	USA	To study the direction of effects between COVID-19 experiences, general well-being, socio-emotional motives for online communication, problematic social media use and insomnia symptoms.	University students.	Online surveys at the start and 5 months later.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social network analysis. 2. Resilience.	Online social capital, understood as the combination of connectedness and online interaction, has been correlated with users' resilience. The results reveal that both connectedness and interaction feed themselves and have correlations with resilience.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social support. 2. Subjective well-being. 3. Friendship satisfaction. 4. Network composition.	1. Facebook use and number of Facebook friends were significantly associated with social and psychological well-being for the cohort aged 18–34. 2. WhatsApp use was significantly associated with social support for all cohorts.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social support received on Facebook. 2. Social support provided on Facebook. 3. Stress. 4. Self-esteem. 5. Life satisfaction.	1. Among students with low self-esteem, providing social support significantly improved life satisfaction. However, among students with high self-esteem, providing social support did not influence life satisfaction. 2. There was no significant indirect effect of receiving social support on life satisfaction via stress. 3. Providing social support on Facebook actually increased stress, which subsequently reduced life satisfaction.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Perceived social support. 2. Depression symptoms. 3. Negative views of self, the world and the future. 4. Twitter data.	1. Following more people on Twitter, being followed by more people on Twitter, sending more Tweets, and having more of those Tweets Retweeted predicted improvement in depressive thoughts and symptoms for those with low levels of in-person social support. 2. Use of positive sentiment on Twitter was significantly associated with a longitudinal reduction in depressive symptoms for people with either high or low in-person social support.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Sleep quality. 2. Depression symptoms. 3. Sleep duration. 4. Positive and negative affect.	1. Overall, increased bedtime social media use was not associated with poorer sleep the same night. 2. Apart from subjective sleep satisfaction, no other sleep variable predicted positive or negative affect the following day. 3. However, in depressed individuals, increased bedtime social media use was negatively associated with subjective sleep duration.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook use. 2. Self-perception. 3. Negative social comparison on Facebook. 4. Life satisfaction.	1. Facebook use was related to a greater degree of negative social comparison, which was in turn related negatively to self-perceived social competence and physical attractiveness. 2. The indirect relationship between Facebook use and self-perception through negative social comparison was attenuated among happier individuals, as the relationship between Facebook use and negative social comparison was weaker among happier individuals. 3. SNS use was thus negatively related to self-perception through negative social comparison, especially among unhappy individuals. 4. Life satisfaction was significantly associated with self-perceived social competence and self-perceived physical attractiveness.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Therapeutic affordance. 2. Quality of life.	1. Participants who used video sharing sites perceived social media use helped them improve their quality of life. 2. Participants who used blogs perceived social media use helped them manage their mental health. 3. Participants who used wikis perceived social media use helped them feel less lonely. 4. Participants who used photo sharing sites perceived social media use helped them feel more supported.
Not applicable.	Associations between measured outcomes and between baseline and 5 months later.	1. Negativity of COVID-19 experiences. 2. General well-being. 3. Problematic social media use. 4. Motives for online communication. 5. Time spent using social media. 6. Insomnia symptoms. 7. Sleep duration.	Insomnia symptoms ($p = .025$) and more problematic social media ($p = .001$) use significantly predicted more negative COVID-19 experiences 5 months later.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
El-Khoury et al.	2020	Lebanon	To study how social media detoxification is associated with mood, anxiety and sleep.	University students.	Online surveys.
Erliksson et al.	2020	Sweden	To develop a Swedish version of the recently developed Social Anxiety Scale for Social Media Users (SAS-SMU), evaluate its psychometric properties, and explore associations between different uses of social media and social anxiety.	University students.	Online surveys.
Escobar-Viera et al.	2020	USA	To compare the influence of social media (SM) experiences on mental well-being between lesbian, gay, and bisexual (LGB) and non-LGB persons.	Young adults.	Online surveys.
Escobar-Viera et al.	2018	USA	1. Examine association between passive social media use (SMU) and depressive symptoms. 2. Assess the association between active SMU and depressive symptomatology.	Adults.	Online survey conducted.
Faelens et al.	2021	Belgium	Examine the temporal dynamics between objective indicators of social network sites (SNS) use, and self-reports of social comparison, repetitive negative thinking (RNT), and daily fluctuations in negative affect using ESM, a structured diary technique.	Young adults.	Participants assessed 6 times per day during 14 days.
Feinstein et al.	2013	USA	This study examined whether the tendency to negatively compare oneself with others while using Facebook leads to increases in depressive symptoms, and whether this association is mediated by increases in rumination.	Young adults.	Completed an online survey. and a follow-up online survey conducted 3 weeks later.
Fioravanti et al.	2020	Italy	Whether abstaining from Instagram (Ig) affects subjective well-being among young people.	Young adults.	Participants randomly assigned to the experimental or control group.
Graham et al.	2021	New Zealand	1. Investigate whether limiting social media use leads to increases in well-being. 2. Assess whether sleep quality contributed to the hypothesized relationship between social media use and well-being.	Adults.	Assigned to either the intervention or control condition.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not Applicable.	Not Applicable.	1. Social media use and its impact on health and social life. 2. Social media detoxification experience.	Descriptive analysis showed that there was a positive change in mood, reduced anxiety and improved sleep during and in the immediate aftermath of the detoxification period.
Not Applicable.	Not Applicable.	1. Social anxiety. 2. Social phobia. 3. Symptoms of obsessive–compulsive disorder. 4. Satisfaction with life. 5. Depression symptoms. 6. Anxiety symptoms.	1. Higher levels of social anxiety were significantly associated with both passive and active use of social media as well as longer duration of social media use in general. 2. Those identifying as women and unspecified gender had higher scores on SAS-SMU compared to men. 3. There was no significant association between SAS-SMU and duration of social media use.
NIL.	1. LGB. 2. Non-LGB.	1. SM usage. 2. Contextual variables. 3. Mental health.	1. Social media serves as a place to form and maintain connection with others. 2. Social media as a source of social capital was more frequent among LGB than non-LGB participants. 3. Five codes described negative effects of SM for LGB users: negative emotional, comparison with others, real-life repercussions, envy, and need for profile management. 4. Social media serves as a conductor of potential protective factors for mental health, with similar frequency among LGB and non-LGB participants. 5. Stress related to LGB identity may be caused by social media, with codes of negative emotional contagion, real-life, and profile management more common among LGB. 6. Social media worsening feelings of disconnect was more frequent among LGB participants, namely feelings of 'comparison with others' and 'envy'.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depressive symptoms. 2. Active and passive SMU.	1. Each one-point increase in passive SMU was associated with a 33% increase in depressive symptoms. 2. Each one-point increase in active SMU was associated with a 15% decrease in depressive symptoms.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Moment-to-moment fluctuations in participants' tendency to compare oneself on SNS, self-esteem, RNT, and negative affect.	Both Facebook and Instagram use predicted reduced well-being, and self-esteem and RNT appear to be important intermediate constructs in these relationships.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social comparison on Facebook. 2. General social comparison. 3. Rumination. 4. Depressive symptoms.	In the context of social networking, negatively comparing oneself with others may place individuals at risk for rumination and, in turn, depressive symptoms.
1 week break from Ig.	The control group kept using Ig.	1. Previous Ig use. 2. Life satisfaction. 3. Positive and negative affect. 4. Appearance processing.	1. Women who quitted Ig reported significantly higher levels of life satisfaction and positive affect than women who kept using it. 2. Positive affect increment depended on social appearance comparison, life satisfaction rose independent of the tendency to compare one's own appearance with others.
1-week vacation from social media.	Control group continued normal usage of social media.	1. General mental health and well-being. 2. Sleep quality.	Taking a break from social media led to a small improvement in well-being. This improvement, at least in part, appears to be due to changes in sleep quality.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Guo et al.	2014	Japan	How social networking sites (SNSs) use by Chinese international students in Japan influenced their perceived social capital and psychological well-being.	Chinese international students in a Japan university.	Online and in-person administration.
Hanna et al.	2017	USA	Explore the role of social comparison and self-objectification as possible mediators of the link between Facebook use and self-esteem, mental health, and body shame.	University students.	Completed paper-and-pencil surveys.
Her & Timmermans.	2020	USA	Investigates the extent to which Tinder users' compulsive use, motives, subjective online success and self-conscious social comparison are associated with their well-being.	Young adults.	Online survey.
Johnshoy et al.	2020	USA	Examine if social media use might serve as an effective coping mechanism to help deal with exposure to a stressor.	College undergraduates.	Heart rate, blood pressure, and salivary cortisol were compared in healthy college undergraduates before and after completion of the Trier Social Stress Test (TSST). Following exposure to the TSST, subjects were selected to use social media, read quietly or given the choice to use social media or read quietly during a 15- min recovery period.
Jore et al.	2020	Finland	Identify and understand different aspects of an individual's behavior due to social media usage.	Young adults.	Questionnaire administered to participants.
Jung et al.	2017	Korea	Explored the relationship between the use of Facebook and psychological well-being (PWB) in young adults.	Young adults.	Laddering interviews conducted.
Juvonen et al.	2021	USA	Examines whether connecting electronically with friends can help alleviate loneliness and emotional distress during the social isolation mandates of the COVID-19 pandemic.	Adults.	Online survey.
Larnyo et al.	2021	China	Examined the impact of social media use on the everyday emotion of international students in China during COVID-19.	Young adults.	Online survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. SNS use. 2. Perceived social capital. 3. Psychological well-being.	1. SNS use for social and informational functions (SIF) increased individuals' levels of perceived bridging social capital and perceived life satisfaction, while SNS use for entertaining recreational functions (ERF) was unable to predict perceived social capital but increased individuals' levels of loneliness. 2. The levels of perceived acculturative stress were decreased by their perceived bonding social capital and increased by their perceived loneliness but had no relationship with their SNS use.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Self-objectification. 2. Extent to which individuals attempt to and enjoy emphasizing their own sexiness. 3. Extent to which participants base their self-worth on their sexual appeal. 4. Self-esteem. 5. Social comparison. 6. Depression and anxiety.	Facebook use was associated with greater social comparison and greater self-objectification, which, in turn, was each related to lower self-esteem, poorer mental health, and greater body shame.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Self-conscious social comparison. 2. Well-being. 3. Perceived physical attractiveness.	1. While using Tinder compulsively and for relationship seeking can increase joviality, they may trigger more negative than positive affect. 2. Feeling unsuccessful on Tinder and making self-conscious social comparisons were positively associated with sadness and anxiety, and negatively associated with joviality.
Trier Social Stress Test (TSST).	1. Selected to use social media or read quietly. 2. Given the choice to use social media or read quietly during a 15-min recovery period.	1. Heart rate (HR) and blood pressure. 2. Salivary cortisol level.	1. Subjects that used social media after termination of the acute stressor. demonstrated a significantly facilitated hemodynamic and a trend for a more rapid endocrine recovery compared with subjects that read quietly during the recovery period. 2. Although the majority (71%) of subjects given the choice of recovery modality chose to use social media, differences were not observed between groups selected to use social media and those given the choice to do so during the recovery period.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Self-designed questionnaire based on past literature was developed.	Feelings and time spent in social media usage were statistically significant in arising negative feelings or emotional imbalance in an individual.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Psychological well-being.	There is diversity of user goals on social networking sites and their significant relationships with psychological well-being, demonstrating the value of a goal perspective.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Satisfaction with electronic contact with friends. 2. Loneliness. 3. Anxiety symptoms. 4. Depressive symptoms.	1. Participants of all ages reported greater than typical reliance on, and satisfaction with, video calls during the imposed isolation, although they (especially the younger generations) used texting and connecting via social media the most. 2. More frequent overall use of communication technologies was associated with greater anxiety but unrelated to loneliness and depression. 3. Greater overall satisfaction with electronic contact with friends was associated with lower levels of loneliness, anxiety and depressive symptoms. 4. Satisfaction was most protective among those living alone.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Anxiety. 2. Depression.	1. Significant positive relationship between social media use and everyday emotion. 2. Self-rated anxiety and depression associated with social media use among international students were generally mild.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Lau et al.	2016	Hong Kong	1. Investigate the association between social resource loss on social media and anxiety and depressive symptoms. 2. Whether the association between social resource loss on social media and anxiety and depressive symptoms were moderated by age 2 months after the conclusion of the Umbrella Movement.	Adults.	Telephone interviews.
Mahapatra & Schatz	2015	USA	Examined how undergraduate and graduate studying in health sciences fields engage in social network sites and if they view their engagement in these sites for social support.	University students.	Online survey.
Malaeb et al.	2020	Lebanon	Examine the association between problematic social media use with depression, anxiety, insomnia, and stress.	Young adults.	Completed the questionnaire face-to-face.
Marengo et al.	2021	Italy	Whether receiving Likes on Facebook would relate to users' level of perceived self-esteem, and increased happiness via the mediating role of self-esteem.	Adults.	Participants answered an online survey and provided access to their objective Facebook data.
Meshi & Ellithorpe	2021	USA	To explore how social support both in real-life and on social media mediate the relationship between problematic social media use and poor mental health.	Undergraduate students.	Participants were recruited for an online survey through the college participant pool.
Pang	2018	Germany	To explore how the intensity of WeChat use is associated with perceived social capital and psychological well-being factors among Chinese international students in Germany.	Chinese international college students in Germany.	Online survey.
Pang	2021	China	To explore how compulsive WeChat use and information overload affect social media fatigue and well-being during the COVID-19 pandemic.	Young adults.	Web-based survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Anxiety symptoms. 2. Depressive symptoms.	Social resource loss on social media was positively associated with depressive symptoms but not anxiety symptoms. The association was significant only among middle-aged and older adults but not younger adults.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Feelings of affection and intimacy, ability to solve problems within the relationship, and satisfaction with these areas and the relationship as a whole. 2. Social support. 3. General well-being. 4. Level of self-disclosure.	1. 57% of study respondents indicated that 'friends' were an important resource of social support, and they felt emotionally connected and an overall sense of satisfaction when they connected with them on SNSs. 2. The reliance for online interactions did not discourage or limit their offline relationship experiences. 3. A positive effect on the use of SNSs to support general well-being including mental health experiences.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Severity of dependence to social media. 2. Depression. 3. Anxiety. 4. Stress. 5. Insomnia.	1. Higher problematic social media use was significantly associated with higher depression, anxiety, and insomnia, but not stress. 2. Stress mediated the relation between depression, anxiety, insomnia, and problematic social media use.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Self esteem. 2. Current happiness.	1. Frequency of users updating their profile and sharing personal content had a direct effect on the frequency and intensity of the feedback they received from other users in their online social network. 2. Positive link between the frequency and intensity of positive feedback received by users and perceived happiness that was mediated in part by an increase in self-esteem.
NIL.	Real-life social supportSocial media social support.	1. Real-life social support. 2. Social media social support. 3. Depression. 4. Anxiety. 5. Social isolation.	1. Problematic social media use was significantly associated with reduced real-life social support and increased social support from social media. 2. Problematic social media use was also significantly associated with increased depression, anxiety, and social isolation. 3. Real-life social support was significantly associated with reduced depression, anxiety, and social isolation. However, social support on social media was not significantly associated with depression, anxiety, and social isolation. 4. Problematic social media use had a significant indirect effect on all three measures of mental health when mediated by real-life social support, such that an increase in problematic social media use was associated with increased depression, anxiety, and social isolation through reduced social support. 5. Problematic social media use did not have a significant indirect effect on mental health when mediated by social support on social media.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Life satisfaction. 2. Loneliness. 3. Bridging social capital. 4. Bonding social capital. 5. Maintained social capital.	1. Intensity of WeChat use has significant positive associations with bridging, bonding and maintained social capital. 2. Intensity of WeChat use is positively related to satisfaction with life in Germany and negatively related to the perceived loneliness. 3. Bridging, bonding, and maintained social capital are also significantly associated with gratification with university life. 4. Bonding and maintained social capital are found to be negatively correlated with the sense of loneliness.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media fatigue. 2. Emotional stress. 3. Social anxiety.	1. Information overload is discovered to have a significant and positive influence on social media fatigue. 2. Social media fatigue significantly influenced emotional stress and social anxiety. 3. Compulsive WeChat use is not positively linked with social media fatigue.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Pelling & White	2009	USA	Attitude, subjective norm, and PBC would predict intention to engage in high-level. SNW use connectedness and interaction feed themselves and correlate past behavior (Hypothesis 1). Self-identity and belongingness expected to improve the prediction of intention (Hypothesis 2). Intentions and PBC would predict high-level SNW use in the 1 week follow-up period (Hypothesis 3). Impact of self-identity and belongingness on SNW addictive tendencies was explored (Hypothesis 4).	University students.	Questionnaire.
Perez et al.	2021	USA	To examine the association between social media use and sleep and whether the association differed by age.	Adults.	Longitudinal Online study of sleep and health across the lifespan.
Perluxo & Francisco	2017	USA	To explore the potential implications of Facebook use in the process of maternal grief.	Women who had lost their children due to accidents or prolonged illness.	Semi-structured interviews were conducted and subjected to thematic analysis.
Phu & Gow	2019	UK	1. To determine which aspects of Facebook usage (intensity of use, time spent and number of 'friends') are associated with subjective happiness and loneliness. 2. To determine how the four facets of Facebook intensity (Persistence, Boredom, overuse, and Self-expression) are specifically associated with subjective happiness and loneliness. 3. To explore how gender plays a role in determining an individual's Facebook usage and intensity.	Young adults.	Online questionnaire.
Pittman & Reich	2016	USA	To determine if text-based social media use predict loneliness, happiness, or SWL. To explore if Facebook use predicts loneliness, happiness, or SWL.	University students.	Cross-sectional survey.
Pontes et al.	2018	UK	To investigate the role of cognitive-related factors and psychiatric distress in social networking site addiction.	English-speaking SNS users.	Online cross-sectional survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Intention to engage. Attitude. Self-identity. Belongingness. Past behaviors.	Regression analyses partially supported the TPB: attitude and subjective norm significantly predicted intentions to engage in high level SNW use with intention significantly predicting behavior. Self-identity, but not belongingness, significantly contributed to the prediction of intention and, unexpectedly, behavior. Past behavior also significantly predicted intention and behavior. Self-identity and belongingness significantly predicted addictive tendencies toward SNWs.
NIL.	NIL.	1. Sleep quality. 2. Sleep duration.	1. After controlling for covariates, the interaction between age and social media remained a small but significant predictor of sleep quality. 2. Greater social media use was associated with poorer sleep quality, the strength of the association increased with age. 3. The interaction between social media use and age significantly predicted sleep duration. Greater social media use was associated with shorter sleep duration and the strength of the association increased with age. The interaction between social media use and sleep duration was significant for individuals between the ages of 38 years old and 99 years old.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Functions of the use of Facebook. 2. Perceptions about the use of Facebook.	1. Six principal functions associated with the use of Facebook were identified by the participants, specifically: receiving support, identifying with other mothers, remembering the child, accessing the child's information, paying tribute to the child, and expressing feelings. 2. Participants reported more positive than negative aspects associated with using Facebook.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Happiness. 2. Loneliness.	1. Those with more Facebook friends reported higher subjective happiness. 2. Loneliness was higher for those reporting a lower number of Facebook friends. 3. Persistence appeared to be an aspect of Facebook usage associated with higher levels of loneliness. 4. There were no associations between aspects of Facebook intensity and subjective happiness, and time spent on Facebook did not significantly predict subjective happiness or loneliness. 5. A higher number of Facebook friends was associated with higher subjective happiness and lower levels of loneliness.
Not applicable.	1. No image-based platforms. 2. One image-based platform. 3. Two image-based platform.	1. Loneliness. 2. Satisfaction with life. 3. Happiness.	1. Text-based platforms showed a weak positive correlation between this frequency variable and loneliness, although it failed to reach statistical significance. Further, this frequency variable was statistically uncorrelated with SWL and happiness. 2. Three outcomes of interest among the full sample showed no statistically significant effects on Facebook (hybrid platform).
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	SNS addiction.	Daily SNS use, weekly SNS use, FoMo, maladaptive cognitions, and psychiatric distress were significant predictors, contributing to explaining a total of 61% of the total variance in SNS addiction, with FoMo providing the strongest predictive contribution.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Primack et al.	2018	USA	To examine the association between positive and negative experiences on social media (SM) and depressive symptoms.	Full-time university students.	Online cross-sectional survey.
Primack et al.	2017	USA	To examine the association between increased time spent on social media (TSSM) and depression and anxiety.	Nationally representative sample of U.S. young adults.	Online cross-sectional survey.
Rauch et al.	2014	USA	To explore the effect of Facebook exposure on the physiological arousal level of participants who then encountered the stimulus person in a face-to-face situation.	Female university students.	Prospective interventional study.
Rogers & Barber	2019	USA	To explore the potential buffering effects of a sleep and technology educational intervention on relations among FoMO and telepressure and sleep hygiene, social media use, and sleep-disruptive technology use.	University students.	Participants completed questionnaires in a laboratory.
Rosen et al.	2013	USA	To test whether the use of specific technologies or media, technology-related anxieties, and technology-related attitudes would predict clinical symptoms of six personality disorders (schizoid, narcissistic, antisocial, compulsive, paranoid and histrionic) and three mood disorders (major depression, dysthymia and bipolar-mania).	Adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Rosenthal et al.	2016	USA	To examine whether negative Facebook (FB) experiences were independently associated with depressive symptoms among young adults in a longitudinal family cohort.	Young adults.	Web-based data collection.
Rus & Tiemensma	2018	USA	To examine how Facebook influences reactivity to an acute social stressor.	College undergraduates.	Participants attended a single 120-min laboratory session.
Sabik et al.	2020	USA	To explore whether people feel that their self-worth is contingent on social media feedback or how this affects psychological well-being.	College undergraduate women.	An online survey was sent to participants.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Depressive symptoms.	1. Each 10% increase in positive experiences on SM was associated with a 4% decrease in odds of depressive symptoms, but this was not statistically significant. 2. Each 10% increase in negative experiences was associated with a 20% increase in odds of depressive symptoms.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depression. 2. Anxiety.	Compared to those who used 0 to 2 social media platforms, participants who used 7 to 11 social media platforms had substantially higher odds of having increased levels of both depression and anxiety symptoms.
Exposure to a stimulus person via Facebook, face to face, or both for 2 min.	1. Facebook. 2. Face to face. 3. Both.	Social anxiety.	1. No significant difference between the two Time 1 Facebook arousal scores, or the two Time 1 face-to-face arousal scores, indicating group equivalence. 2. Arousal significantly increased from Time 1 to Time 2 for participants in the Facebook than face-to-face condition. 3. Time 1 and Time 2 arousal scores for participants in the face-to-face than Facebook condition did not differ significantly. A prior exposure on Facebook will lead to increased arousal during a face-to-face encounter, particularly for those high in social anxiety.
1. Sleep hygiene only condition (STEPS only). 2. Sleep hygiene and technology condition (STEPS-TECH).	Information regarding sleep with no intervention (control group).	1. Technology use before sleep. 2. Technology use during sleep. 3. Social media use. 4. Sleep hygiene. 5. FoMO. 6. Telepressure.	1. No differences between conditions at post-intervention in any outcome variable. 2. Relations among FoMO and social media use were weaker for individuals in both intervention conditions (both interventions minimally reduced self-reported social media use for those with high levels of FoMO).
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Use of technology and media. 2. Attitudes toward technology and media. 3. Anxiety about not being able to check in with technology and media. 4. Clinical symptoms.	1. Each disorder had a unique set of predictors with 17 of the 22 significant predictors being Facebook general use, impression management and friendship. 2. More Facebook friends predicted more clinical symptoms of bipolar-mania, narcissism and histrionic personality disorder but fewer symptoms of dysthymia and schizoid personality disorder. 3. Technology-related attitudes and anxieties significantly predicted clinical symptoms of the disorders. 4. After factoring out attitudes and anxiety, Facebook and selected technology uses predicted clinical symptoms with Facebook use, impression management and friendship being the best predictors.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depressive symptoms. 2. FB experiences.	The lifetime, past-year, lifetime number, and severity of upset of most recent and most recent past-year negative FB experiences were all associated with depressive symptoms.
Facebook use.	Control.	1. Physiological stress. 2. Psychosocial stress.	1. All participants showed significant changes in subjective and physiological stress markers in response to the stressor. 2. Participants who used Facebook experienced lower levels of psychosocial stress, physiological stress, and rated the stressor as less threatening when controlling for gender and emotional investment in the website compared to controls. 3. Results suggest that Facebook use may buffer stress—in particular psychosocial stress—if used before experiencing an acute social stressor.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Self-worth dependent on social media. 2. Frequency of social media use. 3. Reasons for social media use. 4. Perceived stress. 5. Resilience. 6. Depressive symptoms. 7. Self-kindness.	1. Results indicated that having one's self-worth dependent on social media feedback was associated with using social media for status-seeking. 2. Women whose self-worth was dependent on social media feedback reported lower levels of resilience and self-kindness and higher levels of stress and depressive symptoms. 3. Women whose self-worth was highly dependent on social media feedback and who were seeking social status in their online interactions reported higher levels of stress. 4. The present findings suggest that women whose self-worth is dependent on social media feedback are at higher risk for poorer psychological well-being, which has implications for practice and policy regarding women's mental health.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Saffran et al.	2016	Unknown (recruited via social media and email)	To explore Facebook use among individuals who have received treatment for an eating disorder in a group setting (i.e., inpatient, residential, partial hospitalization, intensive outpatient, outpatient therapy group).	Individuals with a history of receiving treatment for an ED in a group setting.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Şentürk et al.	2021	Turkey	1. To determine whether young adult patients diagnosed with depression or anxiety disorders tend to become addicted to social media. 2. To examine the effects of 6 DSM-based personality traits (dependent, histrionic, narcissistic, obsessive–compulsive, borderline, and paranoid) that commonly coexist with these disorders on social media addiction (SMA).	1. Young adults diagnosed with depression or anxiety disorders. 2. Young adults without a mental health diagnosis.	Instruments of the study were administered in the Gazi University Psychiatric Outpatient Clinic.
Seo et al.	2016	South Korea	To examine if Facebooking can contribute to psychological well-being and if so, which aspects of Facebook use could play a significant role.	University students.	Participants completed an online survey and a software was used to crawl their Facebook activities over the past month.
Shan et al.	2021	China	To investigate rejection sensitivity and psychological capital as the mediators between attachment styles on social networking sites addiction.	College students.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Shensa et al.	2017	USA	To assess the association between Problematic Social Media Use (PSMU) and depressive symptoms—controlling for overall time and frequency of SMU.	Young adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Shensa et al.	2016	USA	To assess associations between social media use and perceived emotional support in a large, nationally representative sample.	Adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook usage. 2. Relationships and comparisons to treatment peers.	1. More comparison to treatment peers on Facebook was associated with greater ED psychopathology and ED-related impairment. Conversely, positive interaction with treatment peers on Facebook was associated with lower ED psychopathology and ED-related impairment. 2. Few participants (19.5%) reported that a therapist asked about the impact of Facebook on pathology. 3. Interactions on Facebook could affect patients' recovery and potential for relapse.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. SMA. 2. Hospital anxiety and depression. 3. Personality belief.	1. Patients with anxiety disorders (PAD) and patients with depression (PD) were more addicted to social media than healthy controls (HC) despite similar frequencies of social media use. 2. Dependent, histrionic, narcissistic, obsessive–compulsive, borderline, and paranoid personality features in HC increased the susceptibility to SMA. 3. Borderline and dependent personality features comorbid with PAD increased the susceptibility to SMA. 4. None of the personality traits comorbid with PD had an effect on SMA.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Crawled Facebook data. 2. Perceived social support loneliness, interpersonal awareness.	1. More social interactions with Facebook friends and faster friends' reactions to a user's post contributed to Facebook user's perceived social support and ultimately alleviated loneliness. 2. The association between frequency as well as speed of Facebook social interactions and psychological well-being were more significant among those who were sensitive to other's behaviors and feelings than those who were not.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social networking sites addiction scale. 2. The Chinese Experiences in Close Relationship (ECR) Scale (used to evaluate attachment styles). 3. Positive Psychological Capital Scale. 4. Rejection Sensitivity Scale.	1. Results demonstrated a mediating effect between rejection sensitivity, psychological capital, and attachment styles on social networking sites addiction. 2. Fearful style is predicted significantly and positively on social networking sites addiction. 3. Preoccupied style and dismissive-avoidant style did not have a significant effect on social networking sites addiction after adding the mediating variables of rejection sensitivity and psychological capital. 4. Furthermore, attachment styles also influence the social networking sites addiction due to their dual effect on rejection sensitivity and psychological capital.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depressive symptoms. 2. Problematic social media use. 3. Social media time and frequency.	1. PSMU was significantly associated with a 9% increase in odds of depressive symptoms. 2. Increased frequency of SMU was also significantly associated with increased depressive symptoms, whereas SMU time was not. 3. PSMU was strongly and independently associated with increased depressive symptoms in this nationally representative sample of young adults. 4. PSMU largely explained the association between SMU and depressive symptom, suggesting that it may be how we use social media, not how much, that poses a risk. 5. Intervention efforts aimed at reducing depressive symptoms, such as screenings for maladaptive SMU, may be most successful if they address addictive components and frequency rather than time of SMU.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Perceived emotional support. 2. Social media use.	1. Compared with the lowest quartile of time on social media, being in the highest quartile (spending two or more hours per day) was significantly associated with decreased odds of having higher perceived emotional support (participants who spend the most time per day on social media sites had significantly lower odds of reporting higher levels of perceived emotional support). 2. However, compared with those in the lowest quartile, being in the highest quartile regarding frequency of social media use was not significantly associated with perceived emotional support. 3. While the cross-sectional nature of these data hinder inference regarding directionality, it seems that heavy users of social media may actually feel less and not more emotional support.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Shensa et al.	2018a	USA	To identify distinct patterns of social media use (SMU) and to assess associations between those patterns and depression and anxiety symptoms.	Adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Shensa et al.	2018b	USA	To examine the association between degree of real-life closeness of social media (SM) contacts and depressive symptoms.	University students.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Shensa et al.	2020	USA	To determine if SM-based emotional support is an extension of or distinct construct from face-to-face (FTF) emotional support and to assess the independent associations between each domain of emotional support and depression risk among U.S. young adults.	Young adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Sherrell & Lambie	2018	USA	To investigate the directional relationship between college students' attachment style', social media practices, and relationship development.	University students.	Participants completed an online questionnaire.
Shpigelman et al.	2017	Israel	To understand and describe the views of family members and direct support staff regarding the use of Facebook by persons with intellectual disability (ID) within the context of social capital.	Family member and direct support staff of persons with ID.	Semi-structured interviewed were conducted.
Shpigelman et al.	2016	Israel	To understand how individuals with intellectual disabilities (ID) use Facebook to access social capital benefits, if at all.	Individuals with ID.	Qualitative interviews and observations were conducted.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media use. 2. Depression and anxiety symptoms.	1. Two specific SMU patterns—Wired and Connected —were associated with the most risk of depression and anxiety. 2. Membership in the Wired cluster was most strongly associated with elevated symptoms of both depression and anxiety. This suggests that high-volume SMU occurring in tandem with high levels of problematic use and high emotional connection to social media is most concerning. 3. The Connected cluster also was associated with elevated symptoms of depression and anxiety, but to a lesser degree than Wired membership. 4. 100% of individuals in the Connected cluster reported high levels of time, frequency, multiple platform use, and SMI, whereas the majority (ranging from 61% to 79%) of individuals in the Wired cluster reported high levels among these same SMU variables. This suggests that it is not simply high-volume SMU that is associated with depression and anxiety, but more likely, a pattern of use demonstrated by the Wired cluster.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depressive symptoms. 2. Real-life closeness of social media contacts.	1. After controlling for covariates, each 10% increase in the proportion of SM friends with whom participants had no face-to-face relationship was associated with a 9% increase in odds of depressive symptoms. 2. Each 10% increase in the proportion of SM friends with whom participants had a close face-to-face relationship was associated with a 7% decrease in depressive symptoms. 3. Having no in-person relationship with SM contacts is associated with increased depressive symptoms; however, having close in-person relationships with SM contacts is associated with decreased depressive symptoms. This suggests that using SM to supplement or maintain established FTF relationships may be associated with less depression.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Face-to-face emotional support. 2. Social media-based emotional support. 3. Depression risk.	1. Factor Analysis revealed that emotional support from social media (SM-ES) was a distinct construct from traditional, face-to-face (FTF) emotional support (ES). 2. FTF emotional support was associated with 43% lower odds of depression per 1-unit increase on the 5-point scale. 3. However, SM-based emotional support was significantly associated with 20% greater odds of depression per 1-unit increase on the 5-point scale. 4. This suggests that SM-based emotional support may not function in the same way as traditional FTF emotional support in terms of a mental health benefit.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Attachment styles. 2. Social media practices. 3. Relationship development.	1. Structural equation modeling results indicated that participants with greater insecure attachment had lower relationship development quality (large effect size), whereas individuals with greater social media practices had higher relationship development quality scores. 2. The findings indicated that social media practices contributed more to college students' relationship development than did their numbers of Facebook friends and actual friends.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. The use of the Internet by persons with ID. 2.Type of support from internet usage.	1. Most participants favored Facebook use by persons with ID for bonding and bridging social capital and for normalization. 2. The majority of the participants supported the use of Facebook by persons with ID; they perceived this online platform as a means to integrate persons with ID into society and to help them feel like members of mainstream society. 3. Some participants did not support Facebook use by persons with ID as they felt that this online environment could be risky for this population due to their weaker social skills. There were also access barriers for individuals with low cognitive abilities. 4. Although Facebook use enhances the well-being of persons with ID, findings highlighted the participants' need for formal guidelines regarding social media best-practices for people with ID.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Participants' Facebook experiences, including their perceptions and feelings. 2. Understanding of participants' decisions to engage in specific activities on Facebook.	1. The online participation enhanced their bonding social capital as well as contributed to their psychological well-being through increasing their online visibility, popularity and sense of belonging (through the use of the Like function, by actively posting on Facebook, joining Facebook Groups). 2. At the same time, they experienced stress and frustration due to usage difficulties, which prevented them from enhancing their bridging social capital. 3. Participation in social networking sites may also leverage bridging social capital of persons with intellectual disabilities, but they need a more accessible platform and ongoing support to ensure safe and fruitful participation.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Sidani et al.	2020	USA	To assess associations between parental social media comparison (PSMC)—the degree to which individuals compare their parenting with others on social media (SM)—and depressive symptoms.	Young parents.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Simon & Hurst	2021	England	To examine differences in women's mood, body satisfaction, and hypothetical food choices after viewing Body Positivity (BoPo) posts (featuring average or larger women) or a neutral travel control.	Young women.	Participants completed an online experiment.
Slater et al.	2019	Unknown (recruited via social media).	To experimentally investigate the influence of exposure to humorous, parody images of thin-ideal celebrity Instagram posts on women's body satisfaction and mood compared to exposure to thin-ideal celebrity posts alone.	Women.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Slater et al.	2017	England	To examine the impact of exposure to fitspiration images and self-compassion quotes on social media on young women's body satisfaction, body appreciation, self-compassion, and negative mood.	Female undergraduates.	In-person experiment.
Smith et al.	2013	USA	To examine the effects of online social evaluations and comparisons on body dissatisfaction and bulimic symptoms.	Female college students.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Sriwilai & Charoensukmongkol	2016	Thailand	To investigate the impacts that social media addiction has on mindfulness and choice of coping strategy, as well as to explore the consequences on emotional exhaustion.	Employees.	Participants were given 30 days to complete the questionnaires.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media use. 2. Parental social media comparison (PSMC). 3. Depressive symptoms.	1. In multivariable models, after adjusting for all covariates, there was 51% greater odds of elevated depressive symptoms for every one-point increase on the PSMC scale. 2. The PSMC is independently associated with elevated depressive symptoms among parents.
1. BoPo-average. 2. BoPo-larger.	Travel/Control.	1. Mood. 2. Body satisfaction. 3. Meal selection from a hypothetical menu. 4. Hunger.	1. Women who viewed the BoPo posts featuring average-size women reported more positive mood than the control group; women who viewed posts featuring larger women did not. 2. There were no effects of condition on negative mood or body satisfaction. 3. Women did not make less healthy food choices than the control in either BoPo condition; women who viewed the BoPo images of larger women showed a stronger association between hunger and calories selected. 4. These findings suggest that concerns over BoPo promoting unhealthy behaviors may be misplaced, but further research is needed regarding women's responses to different body sizes.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Instagram usage. 2. State body satisfaction and mood. 3. State body appreciation. 4. State appearance comparisons. 5. Social media literacy. 6. Trait internalization of the thin ideal.	1. Acute exposure to parody images led to increased body satisfaction and positive mood (happiness) compared to exposure to the thin-ideal celebrity images alone. 2. No group differences were found on levels of trait appearance comparison or social media literacy, and the findings were not moderated by trait levels of thin-ideal internalization. 3. The findings provide preliminary support for the use of humorous, parody images for improving body satisfaction and positive mood in young women and add to the small but growing body of research highlighting potentially positive effects of social media.
1. Ftspiration. 2. Self-compassion quotes. 3. Fitspiration and self-compassion quotes.	Appearance-neutral images.	1. Instagram and social media usage. 2. State body dissatisfaction. 3. Body appreciation. 4. Self-compassion. 5. Negative mood. 6. Trait appearance comparison. 7. Trait thin-ideal internalization.	1. Results showed no differences between viewing fitspiration images compared to viewing neutral images, except for poorer self-compassion among those who viewed fitspiration images. 2. Women who viewed fitspiration images reported significantly less self-compassion at post-exposure than women who viewed control image. 3. Women who viewed self-compassion quotes showed greater body satisfaction, body appreciation, self-compassion, and reduced negative mood compared to women who viewed neutral images. 4. Viewing a combination of fitspiration images and self-compassion quotes led to positive outcomes compared to viewing only fitspiration images. 5. Trait levels of thin-ideal internalization moderated some effects (improvements in body satisfaction, self-compassion, and mood were only observed among women with average and high levels of thin-ideal internalization). 6. The findings suggest that self-compassion might offer a novel avenue for attenuating the negative impact of social media on women's body satisfaction.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Maladaptive Facebook usage. 2. Behaviors and attitudes related to eating. 3. Eating disorder symptomatology. 4. Reassurance seeking.	1. Maladaptive Facebook usage significantly predicted increases in bulimic symptoms and episodes of over-eating approximately 4 weeks later. 2. Body dissatisfaction was found to fully mediate the relationship between maladaptive Facebook usage and increases in over-eating episodes, whereas body dissatisfaction partially mediated the relationship between maladaptive Facebook usage and increases in bulimic symptoms more broadly. 3. Reducing maladaptive Facebook usage may be a fruitful target for interventions aimed at reducing body dissatisfaction and symptoms of eating pathology.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook addiction. 2. Mindfulness attention and awareness. 3. Coping strategies. 4. Emotional exhaustion.	1. People who are highly addicted to social media tended to have lower mindfulness and tended to use emotion-focused coping to deal with stress. 2. No evidence was found for the linkage between social media addiction and problem-focused coping. 3. Lack of mindfulness and the decision to use emotion-coping strategy are also subsequently associated with higher emotional exhaustion.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Stapleton et al.	2017	Australia (majority)	To examine the impact of exposure to social media-based social comparison information on self-esteem.	Young adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Stein et al.	2021	Germany	To scrutinize the social network Instagram as a potential cultivation system for young adults' body image.	Young adults.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Stock et al.	2018	UK	To evaluate the contribution of SNSs as a means of health-related information and peer support for the CL/P population.	Parents/caregivers of individuals with cleft lip and palate and in adults with cleft lip and palate.	Two Facebook Groups were analyzed and participants completed an online survey.
Stronge et al.	2019	New Zealand	To examine the association between hours of time spent on social media use and psychological distress in a sample of New Zealand adults.	Adults.	Participants were sent questionnaires (postal/online).

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social comparison. 2. Instagram use intensity. 3. Self-esteem. 4. Contingencies of self-worth.	1. There was no significant mediation observed between intensity of Instagram use and self-esteem, as there was no significant association between the predictor and criterion. 2. Self-worth contingent on approval from others and social comparison on Instagram make a significant unique contribution to the explained variance in self-esteem scores among emerging adults. This may indicate that social comparison on Instagram provides young people whose self-worth is contingent on approval from others an opportunity to exercise their self-validation goals, and subsequently authenticate their self-worth. 3. Social comparison on Instagram mediated the relationship between contingent self-worth and self-esteem. 4. Moderation analyses found that self-worth contingent on approval from others moderated the relationship between intensity of Instagram use and social comparison on Instagram. 5. Although Instagram did not directly affect self-esteem, the significant moderation suggested that intensity of Instagram use is influential when the young person's self-worth is contingent on approval from others.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Instagram use. 2. Weight-related estimations. 3. Body esteem. 4. Dietary behaviors.	1. Mere usage time cannot predict the assumed outcomes; instead, only participants' tendency to browse Instagram's public content emerges as a relevant predictor, connecting to biased views on the physical appearance of strangers as well as more disordered eating behavior. 2. Since Instagram use relates more to other-focused than to self-focused perceptions in the study, it is argued that cultivation theory can indeed complement social comparison theory in the current understanding of media-transmitted body images. 3. Instagram browsing emerged as a significant predictor of dietary restraint—whereas neither participants' actual body mass nor their individual weight satisfaction could be connected to this criterion in a meaningful way. 4. Females were more likely to over-estimate the frequency of body satisfaction in the general population, to hold an unfavorable view on their own body, and to indulge in risky eating behavior. Moreover, the observed relationship between Instagram browsing and the weight ratings assigned to strangers was much more pronounced among female than among male participants.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Number of posts, comments, unique contributors, and post 'likes'. 2. Type and theme of each post. 3. Data relating to the benefits and challenges of participation in the two groups.	1. A content analysis of real-time data identified perioperative care, associated syndromes, and dental health to be particular areas of concern for parents/caregivers. 2. Expectations, experiences, and outcomes of further treatment were key topics of discussion for adults with CL/P. 3. Common benefits of the groups included the ability to connect with others, learn about local events, give and receive emotional support, and obtain quick responses to queries in a semi-anonymous environment. 4. Disadvantages of the groups included a reliance upon opinion rather than medical fact and the frequent use of inappropriate terminology. 5. Social networking sites appear to be a helpful source of health-related information and peer support for the CL/P population, yet closer monitoring of these groups may be required.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Socioeconomic deprivation. 2. Hours spent on activities per week. 3. Hours of sleep per week. 4. Psychological distress.	1. After adjusting for demographics and time spent on various other activities (e.g., exercise, sleep, and housework), social media use correlated positively with psychological distress. 2. Although social media use had one of the largest per-hour unit associations with psychological distress compared with time spent engaging in other habitual activities, the association was very weak. 3. Thus, only excessive amounts of social media usage would result in practical changes in distress. It is un-likely—and perhaps impossible—for social media use to be a main contributor to the oft-discussed epidemic of heightened psychological distress.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Sui et al.	2019	China	To explore whether WeChat app-based education and rehabilitation program (WERP) affected anxiety, depression, quality of life (QoL), loss of follow-up and survival profiles in non-small cell lung cancer (NSCLC) patients after undergoing surgical resection.	NSCLC adult patients.	Participants attended face-to-face sessions and follow-up sessions through WeChat/telephone/clinic depending on their intervention group.
Tan et al.	2021	Participants were residing in multiple countries.	To explore the predictors of negative experiences when using online peer support groups (PSGs) for obsessive–compulsive and related disorders (OCRDs) – particularly those hosted on social media platforms without moderation by trained volunteers, peer workers or health professionals.	Adults in online PSGs for OCRDs.	An online survey was sent to participants.
Tang & Koh	2017	Singapore	To determine the prevalence of addiction to social networking sites/platforms (SNS) and its comorbidity with other behavioral addiction and affective disorder among college students in Singapore.	College students.	Participants completed questionnaires (not specified if in-person or online).
Tavernier & Willoughby	2014	Canada	To examine whether both sleep duration and sleep problems would be predictors or outcomes of two forms of media use (i.e., television and online social networking) among a sample of emerging adults.	University students.	1. 3-year longitudinal study, cross-lagged model. 2. Survey conducted once a year, total of 3.
Thomson et al.	2021	UK	To assess the clinical definition for social media addiction via the presence of an attentional bias.	Young adults.	1. Smartphone simulation on a desktop was used. 2. Participants were split into 4 blocks, 2 blocks in each condition.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
WeChat app-based education and rehabilitation program (WERP).	Simple education and rehabilitation guidance (Control).	1. Hospital Anxiety and Depression Scale (HADS). 2. European Organization for Research and Treatment of Cancer Quality of Life Questionnaire (QLQ-C30).	1. HADS-anxiety score and anxiety rate were lower in WERP group compared with control group. 2. HADS-depression score and depression rate were decreased in WERP group compared with the control group. 3. Regarding QoL at 12-month, the QLQ-C30 global health status score and functional score were higher, while QLQ-C30 symptom score was similar in WERP group compared with the control group. 4. Both the 12-month loss to follow-up and 60-month loss to follow-up were less in WERP group than the control group. However, limited survival benefit of WERP was observed compared with the control group. 5. WERP is an effective way to improve well-being and quality of life in NSCLC patients after undergoing surgical resection.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Hairpulling. 2. Skin picking. 3. Obsessive–compulsive symptoms. 4. Depression, anxiety, stress. 5. Participants' reasons for engaging in online peer support groups. 6. Online peer support group use. 7. Online peer support group experiences. 8. Quality of online relationships 9. Interpersonal support. 10. Treatment barriers. 11. Internalized stigma of mental illness. 12. Information, advice, or strategies caused benefit or negative consequences from online PSGs.	1. Results indicated that barriers to treatment and quality of 'offline' interpersonal support predicted users' negative experiences in social media peer support groups for obsessive–compulsive and related disorders. 2. Thematic analysis suggested that the contributing factors toward participants' negative experiences included: (1) confronting content; (2) misinformation; (3) preoccupation with symptoms; (4) social comparison; and (5) hopelessness about recovery prospects. 3. Participants reported that misinformation, or difficulty determining the quality of information and advice shared on their social media PSGs, created feelings of confusion. Participants also reported finding themselves spending more time thinking about their OCRD symptoms, which led to significant distress. 4. Exposure to a community of people experiencing the same conditions, some of whom had experienced OCRDs for many years, also led some participants to feel less hopeful about the prospects of long-term recovery. It was concluded that using social media peer support groups for obsessive–compulsive and related disorders, without adequate support structures in place, can pose users at the risk of negative experiences.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. SNS addiction. 2. Food addiction. 3. Compulsive buying. 4. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (DSM-5; for affective disorder).	1. The prevalence rates of SNS, food and shopping addiction were 29.5%, 4.7% and 9.3%, respectively, for the total sample. SNS addiction was found to co-occur with food addiction (3%), shopping addiction (5%), and both food and shopping addiction (1%). The comorbidity rates of SNS addiction and affective disorder were 21% for depression, 27.7% for anxiety, and 26.1% for mania. 2. Compared with the total sample, students with SNS addiction reported higher comorbidity rates with other behavioral addiction and affective disorder. 3. In general, females as compared to males reported higher comorbidity rates of SNS addiction and affective disorder. 4. SNS addiction has a high prevalence rate among college students in Singapore. Students with SNS addiction were vulnerable to experience other behavior addiction as well as affective disorder, especially among females.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Sleep duration. 2. Sleep problems.	1. Results of the path analysis indicated that the associations between sleep duration and television, as well as between sleep duration and online social networking, were not statistically significant. 2. The associations between sleep problems and television, as well as between sleep problems and online social networking, however, were both statistically significant, such that more sleep problems predicted both a longer time spent watching television, as well as more time spent engaged in online social networking, but not vice versa.
Attentional capture task.	1. Presence of social media distractor. 2. presence of notification with distractor app.	1. Attentional bias. 2. Social media use. 3. Social media addiction.	The presence of social media distractor apps in mock smartphone displays had no effect on users' target response times, which in turn did not support the presence of an attentional bias to these stimuli, contrary to what has been found for other addiction-related research.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Uysal et al.	2013	Turkey	This study examined the mediating effects of Facebook addiction on the relationship between subjective vitality and subjective happiness.	University students.	Self-report questionnaire.
Van Wezel et al.	2021	Not mentioned.	1. To assess if increased screen time reduction led to greater sustained attention and emotional well-being. 2. To assess if self-control and impulsivity moderates the effectiveness of screen time reduction on sustained attention. 3. To assess if FoMO moderates the effectiveness of screen time reduction on emotional well-being.	University students.	Participants completed the sustained attention tasks and self-report questionnaires on a laptop in a lab. They also donated their smartphone use data of 7 days preceding baseline measurement. They installed screen time limiters for social media apps and returned to the lab after 7 and 14 days, for the same measures except impulsivity and self-control.
Vanman et al.	2018	Not mentioned	To assess the effect of short-term abstention from Facebook on stress and well-being.	Adult Facebook users.	1. Questionnaires were administered online in a computer laboratory. 2. Participants returned for a second session of questionnaires after the 5-day intervention.
Vannucci et al.	2017	USA	To investigate the association between social media use and anxiety symptomatology in a large, nationally representative sample of U.S. emerging adults.	Young adults.	Participants were enrolled in the study through Lightspeed GMI, who facilitated their completion of survey.
Verduyn et al.	2015	USA	To illuminate how Facebook use impacts subjective well-being.	Study 1: University students. Study 2: Young adults.	Random assignment to either of the 2 conditions. Study 1: Baseline measure followed by end-of-day debrief and questionnaire. Study 2: Completed a set of questionnaires, then messaged 5 times a day for 6 days, completed another set of questionnaires thereafter.
Wang et al.	2020	China	Examining the relation between upward social comparison on mobile social media (MSM) and married adults' depression.	Married adults.	Online survey via SOJUMP and paper-and-pencil survey.
Ward et al.	2018	USA	To better understand social media (SM) use in adults with autism spectrum disorder (ASD), with a particular focus on the relationship between SM use and happiness and the role of platform in this relationship.	Adults with self-reported ASD.	Online survey.

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook addiction. 2. Subjective vitality. 3. Subjective happiness.	Facebook addiction can partially explain the relationship between subjective vitality and subjective happiness.
Use of social media apps screen time limiter for experimental group.	Experimental and control group.	1. Sustained attention. 2. Emotional well-being. 3. Self-control. 4. FoMO. 5. Impulsivity.	1. Manipulation failed mostly because participants in the control group reduced their social media app use on average with 38%, which was much more than the intended 10%; no differences between the two conditions in terms of their overall average reduction in screen time. 2. The intervention had no main effect on the behavioral measures of sustained attention. Compared to the week prior to the baseline measure, participants experienced significantly less attentional lapses and cognitive errors due to these during the intervention week. The experimental group experienced significantly more cognitive errors overall than the control. There was no interaction effect. 3. None of the included moderators (FoMO, impulsivity and self-control) showed significant moderator's effects. 4. Overall, the results did not support the hypotheses that a 50% social media screen time restriction leads to better attentional performance and greater emotional well-being than a 10% restriction, nor the hypotheses that self-control, impulsivity and FoMO would consistently moderate these effects.
Not using Facebook for 5 days.	Participants randomly placed in control or no Facebook groups.	1. Perceived stress and well-being. 2. Saliva cortisol level.	1. Experimental condition affected life satisfaction over time, such that the Facebook Normal group had a greater (positive) change from Session 1 to Session 2 than did the No Facebook group. 2. Both groups reported a decline in perceived stress from Session 1 to Session 2, but this difference was not affected by condition. 3. Taking a break from Facebook led to lower cortisol levels after just 5 days. However, participants who gave up Facebook reported lower life satisfaction than those who maintained normal Facebook usage.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Dispositional anxiety symptoms. 2. Anxiety-related impairment. 3. Social media use.	1. Higher daily social media use was significantly associated greater dispositional anxiety symptoms, but was associated with recent anxiety-related impairment only at a trend level. 2. Greater social media use was associated with increased odds of participants reporting the presence of a probable anxiety disorder.
Study 1: Manipulation of subjective well-being (SWB) via active versus passive Facebook use. Study 2: Manipulation of subjective well-being (SWB) via active versus passive Facebook use for 1 week.	Active and passive Facebook use.	Subjective well-being.	Study 1: Neither passive use nor active use participants displayed changes in affect immediately following the manipulation. However, passive use participants displayed a significant drop in affective well-being at the end of the day relative to both their baseline and post-manipulation affect levels; active use participants did not. The two groups also differed significantly on end of the day affect. Study 2: 1. Passive Facebook usage predicted declines in how good people felt over time, but active Facebook usage did not. 2. The relationship between passive Facebook usage and changes in affective well-being was not moderated by participants' number of Facebook friends, their perceptions of Facebook network support, depressive symptoms, loneliness, gender, self-esteem, or their motivation for using Facebook.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depression, envy. 2. Marital quality.	1. Upward social comparison on MSM was positively correlated with depression and envy. There was also a positive correlation between envy and depression. 2. Bootstrapping indicated that there was a significant role of envy in explaining the association between upward social comparison via MSM and depression. 3. Higher levels of marital quality weakened the positive effect of upward social comparison on depression and envy.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media use. 2. Subjective happiness.	1. As Facebook hours increased, happiness increased up to the point where Facebook use was the highest, at which point happiness levels fell off. 2. Individuals who used SM reported being happier than those who did not and Facebook users reported greater happiness than nonusers. 3. No differences were found between Twitter users and nonusers. However, users of Facebook users reported greater happiness than Twitter users.

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Wen et al.	2016	China	To examine whether the use of WeChat will lead to people's subjective well-being (SWB).	University students from the city and countryside.	Collected the data through an online data collection platform, SOJUMP.
Wong et al.	2020	China	To explore how severities of Internet Gaming Disorder (IGD) and Social Media Addiction (SMA) relate to sleep quality and emotional distress in a population at risk of internet addiction (i.e., young adults).	University students.	Online survey.
Wright et al.	2018	Australia	To establish a preliminary inventory of potential false self-presentation behaviors on Facebook, and investigate potential predictors of this behavior.	Young adult Facebook users.	Questionnaire administered to young adult Facebook users.
Wright et al.	2013	USA	Exploring the inter-relationships between motives, communication competence, social support, and depression.	Adult university students.	Self-report questionnaire.
Xie & Karan	2019	USA	To examine Facebook addiction and state anxiety without Facebook. Also assess the interaction effect between gender and trait anxiety.	University students.	Online survey.
Xu et al.	2016	China	To identify the relationship between WeChat use and sleep quality of undergraduate students.	University students.	Questionnaire administered.
Yang	2016	US	To clarify the associations between loneliness and specific SNS activities. Explored how social comparison orientation (SCO) would moderate the relationships between SNS activities and loneliness.	University students.	Online survey of participants that use Instagram for at least a few times a week.
Yang et al.	2018	USA	To assess if college freshmen's social comparison of ability and opinion on social media would predict identity distress differentially through their respective associations with rumination and reflection.	College students.	Initial online survey in the fall semester (T1), follow-up survey at spring semester (T2).

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Subjective well-being.	Intrinsic motivation has a complete mediating effect on the relationship between use intensity and life satisfaction.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Depression. 2. Anxiety. 3. Stress. 4. Sleep quality.	1. Both IGD and SMA were associated with all outcome variables (i.e., depression, anxiety, stress, and sleep quality) after controlling for age, gender, time spent on smartphones, time spent on social media, and time spent gaming. 2. IGD had a higher association with depression, anxiety, and stress as compared to SMA without significance. In contrast, SMA had a significantly higher association with poor sleep quality as compared to IGD scores.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Psychological well-being. 2. Depression. 3. Stress. 4. Anxiety. 5. Lying behavior. 6. Liking behavior.	1. Lying behavior: the only significant predictor was moral norms. 2. Liking behavior: the significant predictors were age, self-esteem, moral norms, and group norms. 3. There was a significant relationship between anxiety and lying behaviors and a significant relationship between stress, anxiety, depression, and liking behaviors.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social support network size. 2. Satisfaction. 3. Computer-mediated communication (CMC) competence. 4. Depression.	1. Interpersonal communication motives were positively related to communication competence (interpersonal communication competence and CMC competence). 2. However, social integrative motives were not found to be positively related to communication competence. 3. Furthermore, competence was positively related to face-to-face social support satisfaction and social support satisfaction on Facebook. 4. Last, face-to-face social support satisfaction and Facebook social support satisfaction were negatively related to depression.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Facebook intensity. 2. Facebook addiction. 3. Trait anxiety. 4. State anxiety.	1. Trait anxiety was a positive predictor for both Facebook addiction and state anxiety without Facebook. 2. People with higher level of Facebook addiction reported higher level of state anxiety without Facebook. 3. Among people with lower level of trait anxiety, females had higher level of Facebook addiction than males. 4. The more intensively people used Facebook, the more addicted they were to it and the more anxious they felt when separated from Facebook. Facebook use intensity was the strongest predictor and explained 31.8% of the variances in Facebook addiction and 31.2% of the variances in state anxiety without Facebook. 5. Hierarchical regression analysis showed that SNS use for broadcasting such as status updating, sharing photos, or sharing videos increased both Facebook addiction and Facebook state anxiety.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Sleep quality.	1. Compared with nonusers, WeChat users had a lower score of subjective quality of sleep, sleep latency, use of sleeping medication, habitual sleep efficiency, daytime dysfunction, and global sleep quality score. 2. Compared with females, males had a lower score of subjective quality of sleep, sleep latency, habitual sleep efficiency, sleep disorders, daytime dysfunction and global sleep quality score. However, females had a lower score of sleep duration than males.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Loneliness. 2. SCO.	1. Both Instagram interaction and Instagram browsing were related to lower loneliness, whereas Instagram broadcasting was associated with higher loneliness. 2. SCO moderated the relationship between Instagram interaction and loneliness such that Instagram interaction was related to lower loneliness, but only for users who were less inclined to compare themselves with others.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Rumination. 2. Reflection. 3. Identity distress.	1. Social comparison of ability on social media had a positive association with T1 concurrent rumination, which in turn predicted higher identity distress at T2. The overall indirect path was significant. 2. Social comparison of opinion on social media had a positive relationship with concurrent reflection, which, however, did not predict identity distress.

(Continues)

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TABLE 3 (Continued)

Author	Year of publication	Country	Aims	Study population	Methodology
Yildiz Durak & Seferoğlu	2019	Turkey	To determine the levels of problematic social media usage of active social media users and examine the relations between the problematic social media usage, various personal characteristics, and personal and social variables.	Young adults who are frequent users of social media on smartphones.	Online survey.
Yu et al.	2020	Taiwan	To assess the effect of savoring via social media usage to boost positive emotions.	University students.	Initial survey then random assignment to no-treatment and savoring treatment group. Study included a post-test immediately after and follow-up test 4 weeks later.
Yuen et al.	2019	USA	To examine in college students (a) the effects of active versus passive Facebook use on mood, (b) potential mediators (e.g., envy, perceived meaningfulness) of Facebook's effect on mood, and (c) the relationship between type of information (i.e., source, valence) viewed on Facebook and mood.	University undergraduates.	Initial survey then randomly assigned to one of four conditions for 20 min, followed by post-test survey.
Zhang et al.	2021	China	To examine the effectiveness of a mindfulness-based intervention on reducing prenatal stress compared to participation in health education groups.	Pregnant women.	20-min face-to-face pre-intervention guidance session, followed by program files sent daily via WeChat.
Zhao & Zhou	2020	China	To investigate whether and how social media exposure to COVID-19 was associated with various mental health outcomes.	College students.	Online survey.
Zhou & Zhang	2019	China	To explore whether online social networking tool use has any effect on individuals' well-being, and whether this effect is mediated by envy or fatigue.	University students.	Online survey.

mood ($n = 21$, 18.8%); social capital and social support ($n = 17$, 15.2%); loneliness ($n = 11$, 9.8%); and fatigue ($n = 5$, 4.5%). Quality of life was investigated in two studies (Dodemaide et al., 2021; Sui et al., 2019); resilience in three (Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Castillo De Mesa et al., 2019; Sabik et al., 2020); envy in three (Wang et al., 2020; Yuen et al., 2019; Zhou & Zhang, 2019); and fear of missing out (FoMO) in three (Pontes et al., 2018; Rogers & Barber, 2019; van Wezel et al., 2021). Lastly, mindfulness and coping were addressed in one study (Sriwilai & Charoensukmongkol, 2016).

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Interventions	Groups/ comparison	Outcome measure	Key findings
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Social media disorder. 2. Social anxiety. 3. Loneliness. 4. Social desirability.	1. There is a significant relationship between problematic social media usage and the daily use of social media, the use frequency of social media for recognition, publicity, communication/interaction and education, loneliness and social anxiety. The social interaction is the most correlated variable with problematic social media usage. 2. Those who have high social desirability tendency also have high loneliness and social anxiety scores.
Experimental participants were told to do something they enjoy each week and post about it on social media.	Comparison between experimental and control group.	1. Positive affect (PA). 2. Negative affect (NA). 3. Depression.	1. At post-test, significant differences were found, suggesting that the mean PA scores for the experimental group were higher than those of the control group. 2. At follow-up, significant differences were also, which suggests that the effects of savoring intervention continued from the post-test stage to the follow-up stage. 3. The results indicate that the positive savoring intervention had an immediate effect for reducing depression, but the effects did not last till follow-up stage.
1. Surveillance condition: only browse. 2. Communicate condition: actively communicate with others. 3. Profile condition: stay on their own profile pages. 4. Control condition: browse the web except social networking sites.	Compared between 3 experimental and 1 control group.	1. Positive mood. 2. Perceived meaningfulness. 3. Facebook envy.	1. Facebook use led to significantly lower positive mood compared with browsing the Internet. Viewing Facebook pages passively lead to significantly lower positive mood compared with simply browsing the Internet. 2. Participants who used Facebook (regardless of the nature of usage) perceived the activity as significantly less meaningful than those who browsed the Internet. Facebook usage (compared with browsing the Internet) was viewed as a less meaningfulness activity which, in turn, led to lowered positive mood. 3. A partial positive correlation (controlling for baseline negative affect) was found between negative mood and viewing information posted by a former romantic partner. A partial positive correlation (controlling for baseline positive affect) was also found between positive mood and viewing information posted by a current romantic partner. 4. Those with higher baseline negative affect were more likely to view information from one's current partner. Viewing information posted by acquaintances was associated with decreased positive affect.
4-week mindfulness-based program.	1. Mindfulness. 2. Health education.	1. Depression. 2. Anxiety. 3. Perceived stress. 4. Fatigue.	The results supported greater improvement in terms of perceived stress, fatigue, positive affect, negative affect, and mindfulness in the intervention group than in the control group.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Negative affect. 2. Secondary traumatic stress (STS). 3. Depression. 4. Anxiety.	1. Associations of social media use with STS, depression, and anxiety were significant, suggesting that participants who spent more time on social media reported more mental health problems. 2. At a high level of the COVID-19 stressor, participants with a greater amount of social media use reported a significantly higher level of depression. 3. More exposure to disaster news via social media was associated with greater depression for participants with high (but not low) levels of the disaster stressor. 4. Social media use was indirectly associated with higher levels of STS, depression, and anxiety through negative affect.
Not applicable.	Not applicable.	1. Fatigue. 2. Envy. 3. Subjective well-being.	1. The indirect effect of WeChat use on subjective well-being via both envy and fatigue was significant. Thus, support for the mediating role of both envy and fatigue was indicated. 2. Social media maintains a direct positive effect on flourishing. 3. Increased social media usage that leads to increased envy is negatively associated with flourishing.

Factors affecting social media use-induced impacts

Five studies investigated personality traits affecting the extent of social media use-induced impacts on mental health and well-being (Atroszko et al., 2018; Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Rosen et al., 2013; Şentürk et al., 2021; Xie & Karan, 2019). Other factors affecting such impacts were identified: the frequency (Brailovskaia et al., 2018, 2021; Meshi & Ellithorpe, 2021; Pontes et al., 2018; Primack et al., 2017; Shensa et al., 2017; Shensa, Sidani, Dew, et al., 2018; Vannucci et al., 2017; Wright et al., 2018; Zhao & Zhou, 2020); active or

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passive use (Aalbers et al., 2019; Erliksson et al., 2020; Escobar-Viera et al., 2018; Verduyn et al., 2015; Yuen et al., 2019); and the lack of use (El-Khoury et al., 2020; Fioravanti et al., 2020; Graham et al., 2021; Vanman et al., 2018). Lastly, the influences of attachment styles on social media addiction were addressed by Shan et al. (2021).

Social media use-induced impacts on aspects of mental health and well-being assessed

Drawbacks of social media use: A cause for concern

The detrimental impacts of social media use on adults' mental health and well-being represented the focus in most studies ($n=88$, 78.6%). Evidence suggested that frequent use exacerbated users' addiction to social networking sites (Pontes et al., 2018) and stress and anxiety-related symptoms (Brailovskaia et al., 2018, 2021; Meshi & Ellithorpe, 2021; Primack et al., 2017; Shensa et al., 2017; Shensa, Sidani, Dew, et al., 2018; Vannucci et al., 2017; Wright et al., 2018; Zhao & Zhou, 2020), while protracted use intensified anxiety symptoms (Erliksson et al., 2020; Juvonen et al., 2021). Moreover, upon exposure to Facebook photos of other individuals before meeting them face-to-face, female university students in the United States with social anxiety reported worsening anxiousness (Rauch et al., 2014).

Addictive social media use was also demonstrated to relate to depression and anxiety symptoms (Malaeb et al., 2020; Wang et al., 2020; Wong et al., 2020; Wright et al., 2018; Zhao & Zhou, 2020), suicide-related outcomes (Brailovskaia, Teismann, et al., 2020), and poor sleep quality (Wong et al., 2020). Notably, addiction-reinforcing gratification from addictive Facebook use among employees and university students aggravated depression and anxiety symptoms (Brailovskaia et al., 2018). Other implications included higher comorbidity with other behavioral addictions and affective disorders among young adults (Pontes et al., 2018), especially females (Tang & Koh, 2017). Adverse social media use-induced impacts were also reported among inpatients of a psychosomatic rehabilitation clinic (Brailovskaia et al., 2019). Conversely, some evidence showed that modest use exerted only a weak negative impact on psychological distress (Berryman et al., 2017; Larnyo et al., 2021; Stronge et al., 2019).

Certain social media use-related behaviors were observed to affect mental health, such as 'liking' content (Wright et al., 2018), negative social comparison (Feinstein et al., 2013; Hanna et al., 2017; Sidani et al., 2020; Wang et al., 2020), and broadcasting personal content (Xie & Karan, 2019). Users' rumination exacerbated the impacts of negative social comparison on depressive symptoms (Feinstein et al., 2013; Hanna et al., 2017; Wang et al., 2020), while the propensity for social comparison (Yang, 2016) and social desirability (Yildiz Durak & Seferoğlu, 2019) worsened the impacts of social media use on loneliness (Aalbers et al., 2019). Among young adult parents in the United States, comparing their parenting on social media was associated with depressive symptoms (Sidani et al., 2020). *Vague booking*, where users expressed highly personal and emotional content in a deliberately vague manner, was a determinant of loneliness and suicidal thoughts among university students in the United States (Berryman et al., 2017). Furthermore, suicide-related outcomes were predicted by addictive Facebook use among adults (Brailovskaia, Teismann, et al., 2020). Contrarily, reducing or abstaining from social media use for brief intervals improved the subjects' mood, anxiety, stress, and sleep quality (El-Khoury et al., 2020; Graham et al., 2021; Vanman et al., 2018).

Social media use-induced implications on psychological well-being were manifold, including increased loneliness (Aalbers et al., 2019; Atroszko et al., 2018; Guo et al., 2014; Yang, 2016), poor sleep quality (Abu-Snieneh et al., 2019; Asiri et al., 2018; Atroszko et al., 2018; Perez et al., 2021; Xu et al., 2016), negative mood (Faelens et al., 2021; Her & Timmermans, 2020; Jore et al., 2020; Yuen et al., 2019), and negative self-perception (Brandenberg et al., 2019; de Vries & Kühne, 2015). General social media use was related to diminished life satisfaction (Brailovskaia et al., 2021), poor general health, low self-efficacy, and loneliness (Atroszko et al., 2018; Yang, 2016), with some evidence highlighting that both professional and private use could be psychologically detrimental (Brandenberg et al., 2019). In particular, social media use at bedtime was associated with poorer sleep among healthy young adults (Aldhawyan et al., 2020) and individuals with depression (Das-Friebel et al., 2020), and such an association appeared to intensify with age (Perez et al., 2021). While life satisfaction improved among females who quit Instagram (Fioravanti et al., 2020), less life satisfaction was reported among adults who stopped Facebook for 5 days (Vanman et al., 2018). In addition, excessive social media use compromised adults' perceived emotional support (Shensa et al., 2016), eliciting emotional imbalances and negative affect (Jore et al., 2020). Emotional support dependent on social media was also associated with increased odds of depression among young adults in the United States (Shensa et al., 2020). Lastly, emotion-focused coping and less mindfulness among employees addicted to social media could lead to greater emotional exhaustion (Sriwilai & Charoensukmongkol, 2016).

Among young females, comparison to celebrity images resulted in negative moods and body dissatisfaction (Brown & Tiggemann, 2016). Adverse eating behaviors have been found to arise not only from users' body dissatisfaction from maladaptive Facebook use (Smith et al., 2013) but also from viewing strangers' public Instagram content (Stein et al., 2021). However, images of average- or larger-sized females did not affect mood or body satisfaction (Simon & Hurst, 2021). Interestingly, exposure to parody images of thin-ideal celebrity posts and *fitspiration* images alongside self-compassion quotes enhanced users' mood and body satisfaction (Slater et al., 2017, 2019).

Nevertheless, social media use-induced implications on mental health and well-being were found to be also influenced by individual characteristics and circumstances. The impacts of social media addiction on depression varied substantially between adults with different numbers of children, ages, and incomes (Aydin et al., 2021). Moreover, discrimination on social media was positively related to

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depression and anxiety among Hispanic young adult males in the United States but not females (Cano et al., 2020). University students in the United States with higher trait anxiety reported more serious Facebook addiction and state anxiety when they could not use the platform (Xie & Karan, 2019). Among healthy young adults, depression- and anxiety-related personality traits increased their susceptibility to addictive use of social media (Şentürk et al., 2021). Other personality traits, such as narcissism, also appeared to be a determinant of Facebook addiction, where addiction-reinforcing gratification from its use exacerbated anxiety and depression (Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Pelling & White, 2009).

Similarly, fearful attachment styles contributed to addictive social media use among Chinese students (Shan et al., 2021), while the use of WeChat led to fatigue and envy (Zhou & Zhang, 2019). Among Israeli young adults, psychological distress arising from self-perceived poverty and the inability to afford basic resources was aggravated by social media use. However, such distress was mitigated by social media-enabled social relationships (Achdut et al., 2021). Lastly, female college students in the United States whose self-worth depended on social media feedback experienced higher levels of stress and depressive symptoms and lower levels of resilience and self-kindness (Sabik et al., 2020).

Benefits of social media use: A force for good

In general, social media use has been demonstrated to improve mental health and well-being, as evidenced by about one-third of the studies ($n = 37$, 33.0%). Notably, social media-based contact was reported to mitigate depression (Shensa, Sidani, Escobar-Viera, et al., 2018; Wright et al., 2013). In one study in the United States, young adults derived satisfaction from emotional connections with friends on social media and exhibited improved well-being (Mahapatra & Schatz, 2015). In another, social media use was related to healthy living habits among undergraduates and graduates, such as relaxing and socializing (Austin-McCain, 2017). A more extensive social network among young adults contributed to mitigated loneliness (Brown et al., 2021; Dodemaide et al., 2021), subjective happiness (Marengo et al., 2021; Phu & Gow, 2019), social and psychological well-being (Barker, 2009; Chan, 2018; Dodemaide et al., 2021), social capital (Pang, 2018; Sherrell & Lambie, 2018), and resilience (Castillo De Mesa et al., 2019). Additionally, users' engagement in social media such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, or Snapchat served as a buffer in the face of acute stressors among college undergraduates in the United States (Johnshoy et al., 2020). In terms of factors affecting social media use-induced positive impacts, the speed and frequency of interactions on social media were found to promote perceived social support and mitigate loneliness among university students (Seo et al., 2016).

Social safety also offers partial protection against social media use-induced repercussions on life satisfaction (Akin & Akin, 2015). Among undergraduates in the United States, real-life social support exerted a protective effect against depression, anxiety, and social isolation secondary to problematic social media use (Meshi & Ellithorpe, 2021). Likewise, happier individuals exhibited a weaker relationship between negative social comparison and negative self-perception (de Vries & Kühne, 2015).

In narrower contexts, individuals in specific circumstances or with specific medical conditions have also benefited from social media use. For example, women enduring their children's early demise in the United States reported positive experiences using Facebook during maternal bereavement (Perluxo & Francisco, 2017). Greater social capital and peer support through social media use have also been documented for individuals with intellectual disabilities (Shpigelman, 2016) and those with cleft lip and palate (Stock et al., 2018). Moreover, WeChat-based education and rehabilitation programs improved the well-being and quality of life among patients with non-small cell lung cancer (Sui et al., 2019), while increased use of Facebook contributed to greater happiness among adults with autism spectrum disorders (Ward et al., 2018).

Nonetheless, some caveats must be acknowledged. Support groups on social media platforms for individuals with obsessive–compulsive-related disorders lacked professional moderation, resulting in their negative experiences and distress (Tan et al., 2021). Likewise, among young adults in the United States, unpleasant encounters on social media could endanger LGB users' well-being through negative moods, envy, and stress from LGB identity (Escobar-Viera et al., 2020).

Boon or bane: It depends on how we use it

A critical determinant of whether social media use would be helpful or harmful to mental health and well-being was posited to be the users' purpose for using social media (Jung et al., 2017). In this regard, how social media was used represented a more crucial factor than the amount of time spent on social media use (Berryman et al., 2017; Guo et al., 2014; Shensa et al., 2017; Shensa, Sidani, Escobar-Viera, et al., 2018; Stein et al., 2021; Stronge et al., 2019). Negative impacts on mental health and well-being have stemmed from liking content as a form of false self-presentation (Wright et al., 2018), broadcasting personal content (Xie & Karan, 2019), and passive social media use (Aalbers et al., 2019; Escobar-Viera et al., 2018; Verduyn et al., 2015; Yuen et al., 2019). Furthermore, social networking sites increase loneliness among international university students when used for entertainment. More intense use of Facebook among university students in the United States was also the strongest predictor of their Facebook addiction and anxiety while abstaining from Facebook (Xie & Karan, 2019). Nonetheless, when used for social and informational purposes, social media improved perceived life satisfaction and perceived connectedness among Chinese international students in a Japanese university (Guo et al., 2014). Despite its potential to increase social anxiety (Erliksson et al., 2020), active social media use has been reported to mitigate

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depressive symptoms among Chinese university students (Escobar-Viera et al., 2018).

The risk of poor sleep quality was lower among university students who used social media for education (Aldhawyan et al., 2020). Reduced depressive symptoms were reported for social media use aimed at searching for positive emotions (Brailovskaia, Schillack, et al., 2020) using positive sentiments and having others recognize them on Twitter (Cole et al., 2019). An increase in the intensity of WeChat use by Chinese young adults was found to enhance the enjoyment derived from WeChat use, which in turn served as the user's motivation to continue having this form of fun, resulting in greater life satisfaction (Wen et al., 2016). Social support also enhances life satisfaction for university students with low self-esteem in the United States (Chen & Bello, 2017). Furthermore, in a study on Taiwanese undergraduates, savoring, which focused on positive events, was applied to social media use as a positive intervention, yielding a long-term increase in the positive effect and a short-term reduction in depression (Yu et al., 2020). Among Chinese pregnant women, improvements in mood, mindfulness, fatigue, and perceived stress were reported for a WeChat-based mindfulness program (Zhang et al., 2021).

DISCUSSION

This paper represents a pioneering scoping review into existing knowledge on social media use-induced impacts on adults' mental health and well-being. Of note, negative impacts represented the principal focus in the reviewed studies. Such impacts on mental health largely revolved around depression and anxiety (as examined in about one-third of the studies), whereas those on mental well-being more holistically spanned different aspects of well-being, including sleep quality, affect, life satisfaction, social support, and loneliness. Regarding demographics, most studies have focused on healthy young adults predominantly from the United States; only a small number involved LGB individuals and individuals with medical conditions. The findings were primarily based on analyses of self-report surveys, with some studies conducting interventions and comparing them with control groups. Of the included studies, a substantial number demonstrated that social media use-induced negative impacts such as stress, depression, anxiety (Juvonen et al., 2021; Primack et al., 2017; Shensa et al., 2017), and impaired psychological and emotional well-being (Jore et al., 2020; Shensa et al., 2016) would worsen with increased frequency of social media use, especially addictive use (Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Pontes et al., 2018). Conversely, a smaller number found that increased social media use would benefit the users, such as enhancing social capital (Pang, 2018), reducing loneliness (Pang, 2018), and mitigating depressive symptoms (Cole et al., 2019; Pang, 2018; Shensa, Sidani, Escobar-Viera, et al., 2018).

It is essential to recognize the nuances in factors governing the social media use-induced impacts on mental health and well-being. Individual factors such as personality traits could increase susceptibility to such impacts (Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Şentürk et al., 2021; Xie & Karan, 2019), with poorer outcomes being reported for users with existing mental health conditions (Saffran et al., 2016; Şentürk et al., 2021). Of note, positive impacts from active and purposeful use of social media should be differentiated from negative ones from passive and injudicious use. Purpose-driven social media use could contribute to positive mental health and well-being outcomes in this context. Enjoying positive interactions through social networking sites could improve mood (Phu & Gow, 2019), mitigate loneliness (Brown et al., 2021), and even address eating disorders (Saffran et al., 2016). Among international university students, increased use of WeChat enhanced life satisfaction, mitigated loneliness, fostered bridging and bonding, and maintained aspects of social capital (Pang, 2018).

However, dependence on social media to shape one's self-perception and self-valuation could result in maladaptive thoughts and behaviors from self-rejection (Sabik et al., 2020; Stapleton et al., 2017). Even the network size of one's social media account, which has been shown to alleviate loneliness (Brown et al., 2021) and increase happiness (Phu & Gow, 2019), could be a double-edged sword. Among college students, the impacts of Facebook-induced stress on the incidence of upper respiratory infections increased with the network size (Campisi et al., 2012). Similarly, among adults, having more Facebook friends predicted more clinical symptoms of personality disorders (Rosen et al., 2013). While an imperfect substitute for real-life social support, social networking sites represent an essential social communication and connection platform, especially when physical distances restrict face-to-face interactions. Nonetheless, the line of demarcation between beneficial and detrimental impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being remains unclear from one individual to another. There is likely neither a best way for users to minimize such detrimental impacts nor a general threshold to know when to abstain from social media when they no longer benefit from its use.

In the context of the COVID-19 pandemic, social distancing and isolation were introduced as mandatory protective measures, especially in dense cities worldwide. Due to the prolonged lack of face-to-face social interactions, online channels have become new communicative means for people to connect with friends and family to fulfill their need for social belonging and support (Juvonen et al., 2021). Such online contact, commonly through social media use, was protective against loneliness, anxiety, and depressive symptoms among adults (Juvonen et al., 2021). However, prolonged social media use predicted worse COVID-19 experiences 5 months later (Dubar et al., 2021). Information overload from social media use also leads to fatigue among young adults, culminating in emotional stress and social anxiety (Pang, 2021). While social media use might be an alternative for socializing during COVID-19 restrictions, excessive and imprudent social media use could compromise mental well-being and physical health.

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Gaps identified from included studies

Despite valuable insights into social media use-induced impacts on adults' mental health and well-being from the included studies, some noteworthy gaps merit further attention. Firstly, in terms of social media platforms, the studies have mainly assessed the impacts of using Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and WeChat. The challenge in this context relates to the need to keep up with the profusion of new platforms and the evolution of existing ones.

Most notably, TikTok, a platform launched globally in 2018 that aggressively tailors the provision of short videos based on users' preferences, has garnered one billion users since 2021 (Bursztynsky, 2021). Nonetheless, it has not been featured in any of the included studies. TikTok-based content generation typically focuses on content from attractive idols or *influencers* who grab users' attention, where users mimic popular trends (Mink & Szymanski, 2022). The content on TikTok is also constantly and automatically personalized for each user by artificial intelligence to effectively gratify media consumption needs and encourage prolonged use (Montag et al., 2021). Given TikTok's algorithm-based preferential presentation of such viral content, body dissatisfaction and upward social comparison among young adult females may be more rampant than other social networking platforms.

Secondly, regarding demographics, adult populations in the United States and China were over-represented in the included studies. Accordingly, social media platforms that were popular among them might have been disproportionately reflected in the findings. With 16.2% of global social networking site users in Southern Asia and 11.6% in Southeast Asia (Chaffey, 2022), more social media use-related research must be addressed for adult populations in these regions. Moreover, the included studies assessed social media use-induced impacts on predominantly healthy young adults since they use social media the most (Chaffey, 2022). Thus, attention should also be paid to other sub-populations for more representative findings.

Thirdly, regarding factors affecting social media use-induced impacts, FoMO has commonly been cited as a determinant that compels users to routinely check their social media updates (Przybylski et al., 2013). However, only three studies have assessed how FoMO might influence social media use-induced impacts (Pontes et al., 2018; Rogers & Barber, 2019; van Wezel et al., 2021). With the exponential proliferation of social media content, FoMO should be considered an increasingly influential driver for addictive social media use, which may culminate in other adverse mental health outcomes.

Future directions

Insights from this review have paved the way for further analysis into crucial yet lacking areas of social media use research for young and middle-aged adults. Firstly, broader coverage of geographical contexts will be essential for understanding how different social networking platforms are used worldwide. For example, Facebook and Twitter might be the most popular in the United States, but that may not be true elsewhere. Secondly, our findings have discerned age-related differences in social media use-induced impacts between younger and middle-aged adults (Aydin et al., 2021; Perez et al., 2021; Wright et al., 2018). Given the overwhelming focus on young adults in the included studies, future research should also investigate such impacts on middle-aged adults and consider cohort comparisons.

Implications for practice

Given their contributions to general mental health and well-being (Zhang et al., 2021), social media use-based interventions should be further investigated regarding clinical utility to enable adults to engage in meaningful and purpose-driven social media use. As social media use continues to grow in importance and prevalence worldwide, it is also crucial for mental healthcare professionals to holistically understand its effects on the users. In practical contexts, mental healthcare professionals can perform more robust clinical evaluations by paying more attention to not only personality traits that may increase their clients' vulnerability to adverse impacts from social media use (Brailovskaia et al., 2018; Şentürk et al., 2021; Xie & Karan, 2019), but also other predisposing individual factors such as existing mental health conditions (Saffran et al., 2016; Şentürk et al., 2021). Moreover, social media content to which their clients are exposed should be considered when identifying possible sources of negative or misleading influences on their mental health and well-being. After all, given the relatively unregulated nature of social media, both adaptive and maladaptive content may shape users' perspectives (Sabik et al., 2020; Stapleton et al., 2017). Overall, it is envisioned that insights from our scoping review into social media use among adults, especially on the need to incorporate addictive or maladaptive social media use and its negative impacts into mental health evaluation, can serve to inform future practices and research in mental health care.

Strengths and limitations

Our adoption of the framework for scoping reviews by Arksey and O'Malley ensured systematic data collection on social media use-induced impacts on adults. Moreover, we included articles published since 2005, during which social media use grew increasingly common worldwide (Ortiz-Ospina, 2019). Lastly, we consulted university librarians to ensure a comprehensive search strategy. Nonetheless, our exclusion of non-English publications might translate into the loss of data and information in other languages. Furthermore, most studies included participants between 18 and 35, limiting their exploration of social media use-induced impacts on adults from other age groups. Finally, the lack of critical appraisal of included studies meant that the authors could not determine the methodological quality of each study. This scoping review intended to focus on

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the breadth of the literature rather than limiting studies. Unlike a systematic review, this paper was to provide an overview regardless of the quality and risk of bias as recommended by the PRISMA-ScR guideline (Tricco et al., 2018). However, this review only included studies which were published in peer-reviewed journals; therefore, it can uphold a minimum threshold of evidence quality.

Linking evidence to action

- This review has provided an overview of the existing knowledge on how social media use would affect adults and identified areas of research that merit investigations in future studies.
- More attention should be given to maximizing the positive impacts of social media use on mental health and well-being among adults.

CONCLUSION

Our scoping review offers a comprehensive overview of the literature on social media use-induced impacts on young or middle-aged adults' mental health and well-being over the past two decades. While excessive, passive, or addictive social media use compromised their mental health and well-being, positive and purposeful use contributed to improvements. Our findings further demonstrated that the manner of using social media represented the chief factor governing whether its use would beneficially or adversely impact the users, where positive self-perception and positive users' goals were suggested to maximize the benefits and minimize drawbacks of social media use. Given the progressively critical role of social media, insights from this review have collectively highlighted the importance of considering social media use and its impacts on adults' mental health and well-being in mental healthcare practice.

DATA AVAILABILITY STATEMENT

Data sharing is not applicable to this article as no new data were created or analyzed in this study.

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